

POETRY.

BY THOMAS OLDHAM.

O ! should I ever dare profane
With venal touch the hallow'd lyre,
Let me be banish'd from the Muses' train ;
Ne'er let me feel their heart-ennobling fire !
Unworthy of a Poet's glorious name,
Let me be doom'd to everlasting shame !

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK POETRY ***

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H. MERRIDEW, PRINTER, COVENTRY.

PREFACE.

The writer of the following pages has been in the habit, for many years, of amusing himself with the composition of Poetry. Often has he been advised by his friends to publish; and at length, influenced by their persuasion, and feeling a sort of paternal fondness for the offspring of his own brain, he ventures to present this small volume to the notice of the Public.

It contains Poems of many different kinds, composed, of course, in as many varieties of style; and the author has exerted his best endeavours to render them worthy of approbation. The present times—he is well aware—are unfavourable for the publication of poetical works. The booksellers complain generally of the little demand for them. Nevertheless, it is very improbable that Poetry,—if excellent, (as it ought to be to deserve the name,) should ever be totally neglected. The seed of poetic taste is sown by the hand of Nature in the souls of all men; though in a small number only it is by culture brought to maturity.

The author has exalted ideas of Poetry, He deems it—decidedly—the first of the Fine Arts. It is the most intellectual,—the most comprehensive,—the most powerful,—the most delightful,—and, also,—hear it, Utilitarians!—the most useful. In remote antiquity, as is well known, it was chiefly instrumental in teaching and civilising the then-barbarous human race. To lure their wild minds into reflection, it invested truth and morality with the many-coloured garb of Fiction, and introduced them, through their delighted imagination, to their understanding and their heart; while, by the charm of harmonious numbers, it soothed their fierce and licentious passions into submission to the laws of social life. It was believed to have something divine in its nature, and was universally held in the highest veneration. From ancient times, even to this day, it has continued to be a favourite study with many of the most illustrious characters.

Finally,—and let this be for ever remembered, as conferring on it the highest honour! Poetry has been deemed worthy by the Sacred Writers to be made an instrument in the cause of Religion; and by its sublime

descriptions it has assisted human imagination in forming grand, and awful
conceptions of the Almighty Creator!

Park-Fields, Allesley, near Coventry,
22d January, 1840.

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THE MUSE'S TRIUMPH.

What adverse passions rule my changeful breast,
With hope exalted, or by fear deprest!
Now, by the Muse inspired, I snatch the lyre,
And proudly to poetic fame aspire;
Now dies the sacred flame, my pride declines,
And diffidence the immortal wreath resigns.
Friends, void of taste, warm advocates for trade,
With shafts of ridicule, my peace invade:
'A Poet!'—thus they sneeringly exclaim—
'Well may you court that glorious, envied name;
For, sure, no common joys his lot attend;
None but himself those joys can comprehend.

O, superhuman bliss, employ sublime,
To scribble fiction, and to jingle rhyme!
Caged in some muse-behaunted, Grub-street garret,
To prate his feeders' promptings, like a parrot!
And what, though want and scorn his life assail?
What, though he rave in Bedlam, starve in jail?
Such trifling ills the Bard may well despise;
Sure of immortal honour when he dies.
But, seriously—the advice of friendship hear:
Stop short in your poetical career;
O! quell the frenzies of your fever'd brain,
And turn, at Wisdom's call, to trade and gain,'

Absorb'd in passive sadness, I comply;
Turn from the Muse my disenchanted eye,
And deign to study, as my friends persuade,
The little, money-getting arts of trade.
But soon the Goddess, fired with high disdain
To see me woo the yellow strumpet, Gain,
Resuming all her beauty, all her power,
Returns to triumph in the vacant hour;
Weakly reluctant, on her charms I gaze,
Trembling, I feel her fascinating lays;
Roused from ignoble dreams, my wondering soul
Springs to the well-known bliss, regardless of
control.

Say then, ye blind, profane! who dare to blame
The heaven-born Poet, and his thirst of fame;
Ye slaves of Mammon! whose low minds behold
No fair, no great, no good, in aught but gold;
Say! will the Captive of tyrannic sway,
Restored to genial air, and boundless day,
Turn to his dungeon's suffocating night?
Will the proud Eagle, who with daring flight
Sublimely soars against the solar blaze,
And eyes the inspiring God with raptured gaze,
Stoop from his native kingdom in the sky,
To share the breathings of mortality?

How, then, can he, whose breast the Muse inspires,
Restrain his soul, or quench those hallow'd fires?
How can he quit the world of mental bliss,
For all the riches,—miserics!—of this?

ELEGY

ON THE DEATH OF CHATTERTON.

When to the region of the tuneful Nine,
Rapt in poetic vision, I retire,
Listening intent to catch the strain divine—
What a dead silence hangs upon the lyre!

Lo! with disorder'd locks, and streaming
 eyes,
Stray the fair daughters of immortal song;
Aonia's realm resounds their plaintive cries,
And all her murmuring rills the grief
 prolong.

O say! celestial maids, what cause of wo?
Why cease the rapture-breathing strains to
 soar?
A solemn pause ensues:—then falters low
The voice of sorrow: 'Chatterton's no more!'

'Child of our fondest hopes! whose natal
 hour
Saw each poetic star indulgent shine;
E'en Phœbus' self o'erruled with kindest
 power,
And cried: "ye Nine rejoice! the Birth is
 mine."

'Soon did he drink of this inspiring spring;
In yonder bower his lisping notes he tried;
We tuned his tongue in choir with us to sing,

And watch'd his progress with delight and
pride.

'With doting care we form'd his ripening
mind,
Blest with high gifts to mortals rarely
known;
Taught him to range, by matter unconfined,
And claim the world of fancy for his own.

'The voice of Glory call'd him to the race;
Upsprung the wondrous Boy with ardent
soul,
Started at once with more than human pace,
And urged his flight, impatient for the goal:

'Hope sung her siren lay; the listening Youth
Felt all his breast with rapturous frenzy
fired,
He hail'd, and boasted, as prophetic truth,
The bright, triumphant vision Hope inspired:

'But short, alas, his transport! vain his boast!
The illusive dream soon vanishes in shade;
Soon dire Adversity's relentless host,
Neglect, Want, Sorrow, Shame, his peace
invade:

'Glad Envy hisses, Ridicule and Scorn
Lash with envenom'd scourge his wounded
pride;
Ah! see him, with distracted mien forlorn,
Rush into solitude his pangs to hide.

'There to the Youth, disguised like Hope,
Despair
Presents the death-fraught chalice and
retires:

In vain, alas! Religion cries, forbear!
Desperate he seizes, drains it, and expires.'

ELEGY,

(WRITTEN AT THE REQUEST OF A YOUNG LADY.)

SYLVIA ON HER DEAD CANARY-BIRD.

Sweet little warbler! art thou dead?
And must I hear thy notes no more?
Then will I make thy funeral bed;
Then shall the Muse thy loss deplore.

Beneath the turf in yonder bower,
Where oft I've listened to thy lay,
Forgetting care, while many an hour
In music sweetly stole away;—

There will I bid thy relics rest;
Then sadly sigh my last farewell;
But long, oh! long within my breast
Thy memory, poor bird! shall dwell.

Still to that spot, now more endear'd,
Shall thy fond mistress oft return,
And haply feel her sorrows cheer'd,
To deck with verse thy simple urn.

'Here lies a bird, once famed to be
Peerless in plumage and in lay;

This was the soul of melody,
And that the golden blush of day.'

'Soon as the Morn began to peep,
While yet with shade her smiles were
 veil'd,
The sprightly warbler shook off sleep,
And with his song her coming hail'd.'

'His guardian rose, nor scorn'd as mean,
But found it still a pleasing care,
To keep his little mansion clean,
And minister his daily fare.'

'The dewy groundsel was his feast,
Which when the watchful songster
 view'd,
Straight his loud, thrilling strain he
 ceased,
And softly chirp'd his gratitude.'

'Then would he peck his savoury treat,

—

Turn his head sly, and breathe a note—
Now flutter wild with wings and feet—
Then silent sit—now pour his throat.'

'His playful freaks, his joyous lay,
Well pleased, his mistress would attend;
It call'd affection into play,
And gave to solitude a friend.'

'Thus happily his days he led
Even to the ninth revolving year;
Then Fate, alas! her weapon sped;
And Pity laid his relics here.'

TO JULIA.

Should Phœbus e'er desert my mind,
And should the Nine their aid refuse,
Enchanting Girl! I still could find
A theme in thee, in thee a Muse.

Can Fiction any charms devise
That proudly may with thine compare?
On thee she turns her wondering eyes,
And drops the pencil in despair.

Far sweeter are thy notes to me
Than sweetest poet ever sung;
And true perfection would it be
To sing thy beauties with thy tongue.

Let Phœbus, then, desert my mind!
And let the Nine their aid refuse!
Ever, my Julia! shall I find
In thee a theme, in thee a Muse.

TO JULIA.

Sing, lovely Girl! to hear Thee sing
Hush'd is the listening air;
My spirit trembles on the wing,

And no delay can bear.

Those down-cast eyes, that smile
supprest,
Thy conscious power betray;
Yet, Siren! grant the bold request;
Come, steal my heart away.

See, see, those ruby lips divide;
An ivory shrine appears;
There Harmony and Love reside,
To ravish mortal ears.

And hark! they from that sweet recess
Breathe their celestial lays;
The enchanting sounds my thought
possess
With rapture and amaze.

Still pressing on with strong control
I feel the lavish strain,
Till drunk with bliss, my wilder'd soul
Reels on the brink of pain.

Ah! how could I so rashly dare
Contend with Powers divine?
The pride of victory forbear;
My heart is wholly thine.

ON SEEING MADEMOISELLE ***

DANCE AT THE OPERA IN PARIS.

What fine aerial Shape,
In orient colours dight,
Springs from the world unknown
Upon my wondering sight?

Loosely through various space
The lovely Figure flows,
And leaves the sleeping air
Unconscious as it goes.

Hark! a spontaneous strain
Its fairy gait attends;
In concord every sound
With every movement blends.

Lo, now! the passive Form
Moves as the music leads;
Each motion from each note,
Harmoniously proceeds.

By the same sense, methinks,
At once I hear and see;
And ears and eyes and mind
Are all one harmony.

Along my shivering nerves
The mingled raptures thrill,
And strangely take my soul,
And rule it as they will;

True to the magic force,
That shifts a thousand ways,
An echo, and a shade,
It answers and obeys.

But ah! the charm expires.—
Did Fancy thus deceive?

She smiles, and fondly vain,
Would have me so believe.

SONNET,

**ON TAKING A FAVOURITE WALK, AFTER
RECOVERY FROM SICKNESS.**

Ye scenes beloved! O welcome once again!
Forbidden long to my desiring sight,
Now, now! triumphant o'er disease and pain,
I visit ye with fresh, increased delight.

Vine-mantled Hills, whose heights I joy'd to climb,
The Morn's sweet infant breathings to inhale;
River! whose banks I roved in trance sublime,
While fancy-whispering Eve spread soft her veil;

And thou, O Wood, in whose moon-checkered
 shade
The nightly songstress oft has charm'd my ear
Till Morning told me I so long had stay'd:
Hail all ye objects to my memory dear!
Once more, to feel the transports ye impart,
Health wakes my every sense and tunes my heart.

SONNET,

WRITTEN ON MY BIRTH DAY.

Again has Time his annual circle run,
And April ushers in my natal day:
Since first my infant eyes beheld the
 sun,
How many a year has swiftly roll'd
 away!
Full half my thread of life the Fates
 have spun;
What various colours does the web
 display!
Some dark, some brighter; ere the work
 be done
The sadder hues will overshadow the gay.
Yet not to Melancholy will I yield;
Against Despondency and Discontent
Still Fortitude and Hope shall keep the
 field;
Swerving from thee, O Virtue! I repent;
Now! to repel Temptation I am steel'd;
To follow thee I'm resolutely bent.

ECLOGUE.

SPRING.

Muse of the pastoral reed and sylvan
 reign,
Divine inspirer of each tuneful
 swain,
Who taught the Doric Shepherd to
 portray
Primeval nature in his simple lay;
And him of Mantua, in a nicer age,
To form the graces of his artful page;
O, come! where crystal Avon winds
 serene,
And with thy presence bless the
 brightening scene;
Now, while I rove his willowy banks
 along,
With fond intent to wake the rural
 song,
Inspire me, Goddess! to my strains
 impart
The force of nature, and the grace of
 art.

Now has the Night her dusky veil
 withdrawn,
And, softly blushing, peeps the
 smiling Dawn;
The lark, on quivering wings, amid
 the skies
Pours his shrill song, inviting her to
 rise;
The breathing Zephyrs just begin to
 play,
Waking the flowers to steal new
 sweets away:
And now with trembling steps, her
 swain to find,

Fair Delia hastens to the spot
assign'd:
Her faithful Colin waits impatient
there;
How raptured to regain his long-lost
fair!

COLIN.

O happiness!—and am I then so
blest?
Or does a heavenly dream possess
my breast?
Has not her father sternly bid us part,
And for my rival claim'd his
daughter's heart?
Has not my Delia sigh'd the sad
adieu?
Have I not long been banish'd from
her view?
Away, ye jealous fears! ye sorrows,
flee!
This letter, this! revokes the dire
decree.
And lo! she comes! she comes! but
why so slow,
Pensive, and shy, as if oppress'd with
wo?
My Delia!—

DELIA.

Colin! (*They embrace.*)

COLIN.

O my Delia! tell,
What dark ideas in thy bosom dwell.
Is not thy letter true? then give thy
soul
To love and happiness without
control.

DELIA.

O generous Colin! can'st thou, then,
forget
The painful past, and love thy Delia
yet?
Deem me not faithless; stern parental
sway,
Spite of my tears, constrained me to
obey.

COLIN.

Faithless? O no! I knew thy father's
ire;
Thy filial virtue could not but
admire;
Still did I hope, believe, and know
thee true:
The pains I suffer'd thou did'st suffer
too.
Now weep no more; this bids our
sufferings cease,
This letter—heavenly messenger of
peace!—
That promises a more propitious fate;

But thou, sweet girl! the same blest
 news relate;
Chase from thy fancy every shade of
 fear;
Wipe from thy cheek that ill-
 beseeming tear;
And tell thy lover all;—he burns to
 hear.

DELIA.

When Damon first his amorous suit
 addrest
Thou long had'st reign'd the
 sovereign of my breast;
My love, my heart, my soul were
 vow'd to thee,
And none but Colin could have
 charms for me.
With scorn, thou know'st, his
 courtship I declined:
O, that my thoughts had sway'd my
 father's mind!
But Damon's ampler wealth, which I
 despised,
Too much, alas! my doting father
 prized.
What were thy words that sad, that
 trying hour,
When, in submission to paternal
 power,
I sacrificed the feelings of my heart,
And faltering told thee we were
 doom'd to part?
'Part!—must we part, my Delia?'
 did'st thou say,

'Alas! 'tis Virtue's law; we must obey;
But still, to render absence less
severe,
Let us, my Love, Hope's pleasing
dictates hear.
Little of Damon, yet, thy father
knows:
Time his perfidious purpose will
disclose;
Then will thy sire his hasty choice
repent;
And to our loves, perhaps, may yield
consent.
Meanwhile beware, my Delia, O
beware!
Lest Damon's arts thine innocence
insnare.'
Such were thy parting words. Now,
Colin, hear!
Then will thy words prophetic
appear.
Each night the favourite of my
parents came
To boast the matchless ardour of his
flame;
Still did he tease me with his
flattering strain;—
Fool, to suppose his praise could
make me vain!
At length a favouring hour the traitor
chose,
And dared his wicked purpose to
disclose.

COLIN.

Did he? O heaven! the impostor
could not dare;
I would, my Love, thy Colin had
been there!

DELIA.

Just then, most luckily, my sire
returned:
Surprised, enraged, his Damon's guilt
he learn'd:
Then banish'd him, (his advocate no
more,)
With vengeful threats for ever from
his door.

COLIN.

Look! how the glorious Sun, as he
ascends,
His radiance o'er the dew-bright
earth extends,
While the last fogs of conquer'd night
retreat,
And Nature welcomes the reviving
heat:
So thy returning smiles, indulgent
fair!
Dispel my fears and every jealous
care.

DELIA.

No less delight to me thy smiles
impart,
Diffusing sunshine through my
raptured heart;
Hope, like yon lark, has spread her
drooping wings,
And, mounting up to heaven, her
carol sings.

COLIN.

Observe, my Love, the beauties of
the scene;
The youthful year puts forth its
tender green;
Awakened Flora bids her flowerets
rise,
Opening their colours to the genial
skies;
Winter is fled; fair Spring's
melodious voice
Whispers, in every balmy breeze,
rejoice!

DELIA.

The sparkling rills dance warbling in
their beds;
The trees with gladness lift their
fresh, green heads;
From yonder wood responsive
cuckoos sing;
The swallow skims the stream, and
dips his wing.

COLIN.

Objects and sounds of joy! yet,
 Delia, these,
Unaided by thy presence, would not
 please;
Though thousand charms and
 harmonies unite,
Thy favour only crowns the full
 delight.

DELIA.

Now, Colin, duty summons me away;
Gladly I would, but must no longer
 stay.

COLIN.

When duty summons we resist in
 vain:
Yet tell me, kindest Delia, once
 again,—
To give me courage unalarm'd to
 part,
And soothe, till next we meet, my
 restless heart,—
O tell me art thou now for ever
 mine?

DELIA.

Yes, Colin, now I am for ever thine.

ECLOGUE.

SUMMER.

DAVID.

My task is done; no further will I mow;
I faint with hunger, and with heat I
glow.

Well, Giles, what cheer? how far
behind you lag!

Badly your practice answers to your
brag.

GILES.

Deuce take the scythe! no wonder I am
last;

The wonder is I work'd my way so fast;
Sure such another never yet was made;
It's maker must have been a duller
blade;

The bungling fool, might I his fault
chastise,

Should use it for a razor till he dies.

DAVID.

Ha, ha, well said, young jester; though
bereft
Of strength and patience, yet your wit is
left.
But come, good friend, to dinner let us
go;
Tired are my limbs, my wasted spirits
low.

GILES.

Poor David! age is weak, soon jaded
out;
I feel, as when beginning, fresh and
stout;
Your easy task is ended, therefore dine:
I scorn refreshment till I finish mine.

DAVID.

Then to yon grassy bank I will retreat,
Shaded by willows from the oppressive
heat;
There may we dine, and seated all at
ease,
Imbibe fresh vigour with the cooling
breeze.

GILES.

Curse his old arms! so nimble and so
strong;
How calmly did he seem to creep
along!

While I for conquest strove with eager
 pain,
And labour'd, sweated, panted—all in
 vain!
This awkward tool—yet no defect I see
 —
The ground uneven—some cause must
 there be.
He the best mower? let it not be known;
No, crafty Giles, that secret is your
 own.
Fatigue, thirst, hunger, strongly urge me
 hence.—
I'll e'en o'ertake him with some fair
 pretence.

DAVID.

Ha, ha, the foolish vanity of youth,
Such painful efforts to disguise the
 truth!
Who comes? what, Giles! so quickly
 change your mind?
Too wise, I thought, to tarry long
 behind.

GILES.

In one employment when good fellows
 meet,
They should together toil, together eat.

DAVID.

Here let us sit; against this trunk I'll
lean,
You against that; the dinner placed
between.

GILES.

Now rest we silent till our meal be
done;
While in our ears sweet watery
murmurs run.

DAVID.

Right! when the body feels recruited
force,
More eloquently will the mind
discourse.

GILES.

Now, David, I'll attempt a loftier strain;
Listen, and judge of my poetic vein.
See Phœbus his meridian height attains,
And, like a king, in all his splendour
reigns;
Beneath his scorching radiance Nature
lies
Feverish and faint; her beauteous
verdure dies;
Oppress'd and panting with the sultry
heat,
The flocks and herds to shades or
streams retreat;

Through the still air no Zephyr dares to
play,}
Lest his soft pinion melt in heat away;}
But if, to mitigate the solar ray,}
A lucid cloud should kindly intervene;
Then the glad Zephyrs sport beneath
the grateful screen.

DAVID.

How beautiful the thoughts! and how
sublime!
Rich is the language, and exact the
rhyme.
Inform me, friend, are those fine strains
your own?
They rise superior to the rustic tone.

GILES.

Why not be mine? does then the gift of
song
To wealth and rank exclusively belong?
Fancy with choice unbribed her few
selects,
Nor affluence, nor exalted birth
respects;
The kingly mansion she will oft
forsake,
Pleased with the shepherd her abode to
make:
With me the kind Enchantress long has
dwelt;
Long has my soul her inspirations felt.

DAVID.

I once the feelings of a poet knew;
(Though in my best of days no match
for you,)
But now my genius yields to
conquering time;
Yet still I keep my judgment and my
rhyme;
Then what that judgment dictates I
declare:
No tuneful shepherd can with you
compare;
Although in many a county I have been,
And many a rural poet I have seen.

GILES.

O cease your high applauses, kindest
friend!
For sure my merit they must far
transcend.
How different men in different ways
excel!
My forte is rhyming, your's is mowing
well;
And while to me you deign in song to
yield,
You bear the scythe triumphant through
the field.

DAVID.

That only Youth, whose sweetly-
 flowing lays,
Resembling your's, deserve the second
 praise,
Dwelt near this place—or memory I
 lack—
Yes! now I recollect—five summers
 back,
When to these parts for harvest-work I
 came,
How all the fields resounded with his
 fame.
The Bard I ne'er beheld; but heard the
 swains
Still, with delight, repeat his peerless
 strains:
Not less by Fortune, than the Muses,
 blest,
No cares of life disturb'd his peaceful
 breast;
For poesy alone his happy soul possest.
Did you not know that youth?

GILES.

Full well I knew;
Nor is he, David, quite unknown to
 you;—
That Youth am I!—(with what surprize
 you gaze!)
Then was I blest indeed with golden
 days;
My parents' only child, at home I dwelt,
Indulged, caress'd, nor cares, nor
 wishes felt:
How did they joy my verses to peruse!

How praise each effort of my lisping
Muse!
Then sweetly glided on the stream of
time;
I tended flocks, or meditated rhyme.
Alas! my friend, those blissful hours
are o'er,
My then-propitious stars now rule no
more.
Long has my Father slept among the
dead:—
With his last breath my joys, my hopes
all fled.
The wealth he left, which might our
woes have eased,
His greedy creditors unpitying seized:
My Mother and myself (our sole
resource)
For livelihood to labour took recourse.

DAVID.

Affecting tale! I've heard it with a tear.

GILES.

No longer sit we idly chatting here;
The village clock has struck; come, let
us up!
To-night, friend David, we'll together
sup.

EPISTLE

TO A FRIEND.

Has then, the Paphian Queen at length
prevail'd?
Has the sly little Archer, whom my
Friend
Once would despise, with all his boyish
wiles,
Now taken ample vengeance, made
thee feel
His piercing shaft, and taught thy heart
profane
With sacred awe, repentant, to confess
The Son of Venus is indeed a God?
I greet his triumph; for he has but
claim'd
His own; the breast that was by Nature
form'd
And destined for his temple Love has
claim'd.

The great, creating Parent, when she
breathed
Into thine earthly frame the breath of
life,
Indulgent conferr'd on thee a soul
Of finer essence, capable to trace,
To feel, admire, and love, the fair, the
good,
Wherever found, through all her
various works.

And is not Woman, then, her fairest
work,
Fairest, and oft her best? endowed with
gifts
Potent to captivate, and softly rule
The hearts of all men? chiefly such as
thou,
By partial Nature favour'd from the
birth?
Why wast thou, then, reluctant to
confess
The sovereignty of Love? so strangely
deaf
Through half thy genial season to the
voice
Of Nature, kindly calling thee to taste
Felicity congenial to thy soul?
This was the secret cause:—inscrutable
To vulgar minds, who fancied thee
foredoom'd
To celibacy, for thyself alone
Existing; but I rightlier judged my
Friend—
The cause was this: there lurk'd within
thy breast
A visionary flame; for, while retired
In solitude, on classic lore intent,
Thy fancy, to console thee for the loss
Of female intercourse, conceived a
Maid,
With each soft charm, each moral
grace, adorn'd,
Fit Empress of thy soul; and oft would
Hope
Gaze on the lovely phantom, till at
length

She dared to stand on disappointment's
verge,
Anticipating such thy future bride.
What wonder, then, that Chloe's golden
locks
Should weave no snare for thee? that
Delia's eyes,
So darkly bright, should innocently
glance,
Nor dart their lightnings through thy
kindling frame?
That many a Fair should unregarded
pass,
So far unlike the picture in thy mind?
At last, in happy hour, my Friend
beheld
Partial, a Maid of mild, engaging mien,
Of artless manners, affable, and gay,
Yet modestly reserved, with native taste
Endued, with genuine feeling, with a
heart
Expansive, generous, and a mind well-
taught,
Well-principled in things of prime
concern.
Still, as, with anxious doubt, thou didst
pursue
The delicate research, new virtues
dawn'd
Upon thy ravish'd view:—'twas She!
—'twas She!
Then marvelling Fancy saw her image
live;
And Hope her dream fulfill'd; then
triumph'd Love;
And Nature was obeyed.—

Commanding silence to the vulgar
 quire;
Apollo smiles, and all the tongues of
 Fame
Through the poetic realm Delille
 proclaim.

O let a British Bard, admiring, greet
Thy glorious triumph, and thy praise
 repeat!
When merit claims the panegyric lay,
Envy he scorns, and joys the debt to
 pay.
Painter of Nature hail! to thee belong
Unrivall'd talents for descriptive song:
While others, fired with more ambitious
 views,
Invoke the Epic, or the Tragic Muse,
And, throned in Glory's temple, shine
 sublime,
Proud of their laurel-wreaths that fear
 not Time,
Thy Genius fondly stoops to softer
 themes,
The landscape's beauties—flowers, and
 groves, and streams,
And round his brows in modest triumph
 wears
A simple garden-wreath, but ever
 green, as theirs.

What though, some critics, in their taste
 severe,
Turn from thy subject a disdainful ear,
Demanding still, their duller minds to
 strike,

War, passion, plot, surprises—and the
like?

Yet will true Taste, that ranges
unconfined,
And feels the charms of every various
kind,
Oft quit Voltaire, or Corneille, to
peruse,
Delille! the milder beauties of thy
Muse;
Oft love, with thee, through rural
scenes to stray,
And sweetly study Nature in thy lay.

But, ah! what boldness does thy breast
inspire?
Say, wilt thou dare to touch the
Mantuan lyre?
Long has thy country wish'd that classic
spoil,
Yet, of her tongue distrustful, shunn'd
the toil;
O cease then!—but thy hand essays the
strings,—
Amazement!—Fancy cries, 'tis Virgil
sings!
The same thy numbers, so correctly
free,
So full of sweetness, full of majesty!

Now, France, exult! nor view with envy
more
Surrounding nations rich in Roman
lore;
Delille has sung; then glory in his
name,

Engraved, immortal, on the rolls of
Fame.

ODE

WRITTEN ON THE NIGHT OF THE ILLUMINATIONS FOR
LORD HOWE'S VICTORY ON 1ST JUNE, 1793.

Whence the shouts of public joy,
Whence the galaxies of light,
That strike the deafen'd ear?
That charm the dazzled sight?
While Night, arrested in her highest way,
Stands wondering at the scene, and doubtful of her
sway?
Hark! Fame exalts her voice:—
'Britannia triumphs, let her sons rejoice!
The Gallic Foe, that dared her vengeance brave,
Lies whelm'd in death beneath the blood-stain'd
wave;
Britannia thunder'd o'er the rebel main,
His distant billows heard, and own'd her awful
reign.'

Be hush'd my soul! in still amazement mourn!
O fly the giddy train!
From their inhuman transports turn
With pity,—with disdain!
Strip, strip, from Victory the fair disguise,
And let her own dire form appal thine eyes!
Ah, mark her triumphs in yon hideous scene!
Myriads of brother-men untimely slain;

Hear the deep groan, survey the dying mien,
Convulsed with agonies of pain;
And hark! what cries of wretchedness resound
Throughout the troubled air!
Widows and Orphans doom'd a helpless prey
To famine and despair!
And does ambition glory? Oh! the shame!
The direful outrage to the human name!
Nature herself is moved, the blushing stars retire,
And sudden storms denounce high heaven's
awaken'd ire.

See the black firmament divide!
The almighty sword, with heavenly lustre bright,
Flashes on the sight
Terrific glory, dazzling mortal pride;
The parted concave closes, while around
Deep, rushing peals resound,
Scatter the clouds, in airy tempest hurl'd,
And shake the solid pillars of the world.
As breathing from the tomb,
A death-like stillness reigns,
Save that in Fancy's jealous ear
A sad, prophetic breeze complains
Of some impending doom,
While every soul is lost in vacancy and fear.

Now while Ambition lies in sleep unblest,
Portentous visions haunt his guilty breast:
Borne on a trophied car, sublime he goes
Amid the gazing crowd,
Who shout his triumphs loud;
With haughty bliss his flatter'd spirit glows:—
Sudden deserted and alone,
Confused, alarm'd, in dreary shades unknown,
He hears the wild waves beat the shore,
The din of battle roar:—

'Tis silence! frowning vengeful from the gloom,
Before his shrinking eyes
Unnumber'd spectres rise,
Point to their bleeding wounds, and sternly curse
their doom:

The conscious Murderer starts, the thunders roll,
And hell's dread chaos yawns on his despairing
soul.

But when the morn exerts her cheering power,
And guilt-alarming darkness disappears,
Wilt thou, Ambition! slight the warning hour,
And fondly strive to dissipate thy fears?
Yet wilt thou dare fulfil
The madness of thy will?
Kindle round earth the wasteful flames of strife,
And glut the fiends of war with human life?
Then mask with glory's name thy murderous
cause,
While fond, deluded mortals shout applause?
Yet madly wilt thou dare?—
Devoted Wretch! forbear!—
Cries of the living, curses of the dead,
Have claim'd thy destined head;
And that same Power, whose mighty hand
Once humbled thine aspiring flight,
And hurl'd thee, with thy rebel band,
Down to the deeps of hell and night,
Now warns no more; that Power no longer spares,
Thy sentence he hath fix'd, thy fate he now
prepares.

ODE

TO HORROR.

I felt thee, Horror! rush upon my soul,
Thy hideous band my frightened fancy saw;
Spare me, O spare me! cease thy dire controul,
And let my trembling hand the vision draw.

Lo! what terrific Forms around thee wait,
The monstrous births abhorr'd of Mind and Fate!
Murder, with blood of innocence defiled;
Despair, deep-groaning; Madness screaming
 wild;
Mid clouds of smoke, the fire-eyed Fury, War,
Through gore and mangled flesh whirl'd in her
 thundering car;
 Plague, sallow Hag! who arms her breath
 With thousand viewless darts of death;
And Earthquake, image of the final doom,
That, bursting fierce his anguish'd mother's womb,
Whelms nations in the yawning jaws of night,
And palsies mighty Nature with affright.
 Amid that direful band
 I see thee, Horror! stand,
With bloodless visage, terror-frozen stare,
Distorted, ice-bound limbs, and bristling hair,
Thy shivering lips bereft of speech and breath,
In monstrous union life combined with death.
I see thee still, O Horror! and in thee
Methinks an image of myself I see;
For, while I gaze with fear-fixed sight,
 O Horror! thy Gorgonian might
Turns me to stone: dread tyrant, O forbear!
 To view thee I no longer dare.—

I feel my throbbing heart respire.
Again my fancy with unquell'd desire,
O Horror! courts thee, trembling owns thy power.
Come, let us now, at this congenial hour,
 While midnight tempests sweep
With bellowing rage the ship-ingulfing deep,
While thunders roar, and livid lightnings blaze,
Let us on that dread, watery chaos gaze.
Or from the peopled vale, below,
Uplooking, see, from lofty Alpine crown,
 The rolling mass of snow,
 Into a mountain grown,
 Rush overwhelming down.
Or let us, in Numidian desert drear,
The roar of prowling beasts, and hiss of serpents
 hear;
Or bask by blazing city; or explore,
On Etna's brink, the sulphurous mouth of hell,
And hear the fiery flood tempestuous roar,
And hear the damn'd in hotter torments yell.
Or wilt thou, Horror! haunt the villain's breast,
In dismal solitude, by thought oppress;
 Where guilty Conscience fetter'd lies,
 Turn'd all her shrinking lidless eyes
Full to the blaze of truth's unclouded sun,
And struggles, still in vain, her pangs, herself to
 shun?
Ah!—now more hideous grows thine air;
With direr aspect ne'er dost thou appear,
To fright weak Beings in this earthly sphere;
Faint semblance of thy most tremendous mien,
As, in Tartarean gulfs of endless night,
By agonizing demons thou art seen:
But oh! what living eye could bear that sight?
To look on it e'en Fancy does not dare.—
Oh! may I ne'er be doom'd to see thee, Horror!
 there!

ODE

TO HOPE.

Thou Cherub fair! in whose blue, sparkling eye
New joys, anticipated, ever play;
Celestial Hope! with whose all-potent sway
The moral elements of life comply;
At thy melodious voice their jarrings cease,
And settle into order, beauty, peace;
How dear to memory that thrice-hallow'd hour
Which gave Thee to the world, auspicious Power!
Sent by thy parent, Mercy, from the sky,
Invested with her own all-cheering ray,
To dissipate the thick, black cloud of fate
Which long had shrouded this terrestrial state,
What time fair Virtue, struggling with despair,
Pour'd forth to pitying heaven her saddest soul in
prayer:
Then, then she saw the brightening gloom divide,
And Thee, sweet Comforter! adown thy rainbow
glide.
From the veil'd awful future, to her view
Scenes of immortal bliss thou didst disclose;
With faith's rapt eye she hail'd the vision true,
Spurn'd the base earth, and smiled upon her woes.

Thou Sovereign of the human soul
Whose influence rules without controul!
Unlike thy gloomy rival, Fear,
Abhorr'd, usurping Demon! who constrains

The shuddering spirit in his icy chains:
 O Hope! be thou for ever near;
 Keep the dread tyrant far away,
And all my willing, grateful bosom sway.
Each coming hour, that smiles with promise sweet,
In thy bright, spotless mirror let me greet,
And fondly passive to thy dictates, deem
Those smiling hours all heavenly as they seem:
Should changeful Fortune, hostile in her mood,
With storms and thunder arm her meteor-car,
And 'gainst me summon all her host to war,
Rouse thou, kind Power! the champion Fortitude,
 With his well-tempered shield
 To brave the threatening field.
Amid that scene of woes and mental strife
 Let thy sweet, distant whisper soothe my ear,
 Inviting Fancy far from mortal life,
 To wander, blest, her own-created sphere.
 Do thou her glowing thought possess,
 And let her fairy pencil draw,
 Free, and unconscious of thy law,
 Fair images of Happiness;
Of that celestial form which lives imprest
Indelible, eternal, in thy breast.
 E'en in the dead calm of the mind,
 When Fancy sleeps, thou yet be kind;
 O Hope! still let thy golden pinions play,
The unbreathing void to cheer, and shed a glancing
 ray!

ODE

TO THE DUKE OF WELLINGTON.

This, this is inspiration's hour!
Poetic Genius, rushing on my soul,
Rouses her every sense, her every power,
And with a force too mighty to controul
Inspires the warm, enthusiastic song:
Now will I sing, O Wellington! of thee;
To thee my plausive strains, of right, belong;
For thee my lyre shall pour its choicest harmony.
Long have I fondly mused the theme sublime;
And from my grateful heart of patriot flame
In secret, offer'd incense to thy name;
But dared not with unhallow'd rhyme
Profane the British Hero's fame.
Thrice welcome this propitious time!
Now, joining with my Country's minstrel-band,
Thy deeds, O Wellington! will I rehearse
In lofty never-dying verse,
To which Britannia's self shall deign
To lend a listening ear,
While in thy military, swift career
Triumphantly she leads thee by the hand,
And proudly thrones thee high in glory's fane.

In yonder eastern climes afar
What dawning light attracts the Muse's eye?—
She feels the influence of her ruling star,
And with an eagle's gaze, an eagle's wings,
As to Apollo's self, transported, springs—
'Tis Wellington in Victory's brilliant car,
Who his triumphal progress has begun;
Around him honour's sun
Shoots forth its orient ray:
In wondering India's sky
He rises like the God of day.
Greet him, O England! greet thy conquering Son!

O! could'st thou but foresee
The events of dark futurity,
How would'st thou, then, adore the name of
Wellington!
Know!—he shall soon thy thunders wield
In many a European field,
Confound thy haughty foes with dread amaze,
And fill the dazzled world with his meridian blaze.

To Europe's frighten'd eyes
What scenes of horror rise!
See, from the darkness of the infernal world,
Where with the rebel demons he was hurl'd,
See, Revolution rears his hydra-head!
Ill-fated Gallia is his destined prey.
Thither the Monster makes his furious way;
And with a loud, ferocious yell,
That strikes the earth with dread,
And spreads delight through hell,
He summons all his hideous train,
To strengthen and support his reign.
Broke are the bonds of social life,
All kindred, all domestic ties;
Mid scenes of anarchy and civil strife,
Mid plots, cabals, and murderous rivalries,
Eager for prey, with licence unconfined
Range the fierce Passions of the human mind,
Ambition, Avarice, Anger, Vengeance, Hate:
With frantic men rejoicing devils howl,
And all hell's ravenous blood-hounds barking prowl.
O could oblivion veil that direst page of fate!
The revolutionary storm subsides.—
Lo! now, proud Gallia's Genius towers on high;
O'er half Europa he already strides,
And glorying in his might threatens earth and sky;
The neighbouring nations, vanquish'd to his sway,
Like abject slaves his tyrant power obey.

What conqueror leads the Gallic armies on?
Fortune's loved child, Ambition's darling son,
'Tis the French Emperor, great Napoleon:
And subject to his high imperial will,
His warlike marshals his commands fulfil.
What can resist their overwhelming force?
Has Liberty no succour? no resource?
She has! she has! O save her, Wellington!
Ere yet unhappy Spain be forced to yield,
Fly with Britannic forces to the field,
And pluck the noblest palm thou yet hast won.

The memory of Talavera's day
Still strikes our foes with wonder and dismay;
There did the Briton soldier boldly claim
The honour due to his illustrious name.

On Torres-Vedras' height,
Like Jove upon the Olympian steep,
When he defied the Giant-race to fight,
Thy station calmly didst thou keep,
Despite the vengeful threats of boasting France.
How didst thou long to see her powers advance!
But no: the veteran Chief, Massena, fled.
Swiftly thy ardent troops his flight pursue;
His soldiers fall in crowds; Confusion, Fear,
And Slaughter dog them in the rear;
Famine and Desolation meet their van.
Spaniard with Portuguese in vengeance vies;
New toils they still encounter, dangers new,
Thus Fortune's Favourite, this unconquer'd man
Accomplishes his haughty boast:
Home he returns with less than half his host;
His baggage, ordnance, thine, brave Wellington!
And all his wreaths in former warfare won.

So Albion, throned upon her rocky seat,

Sees the proud-swelling billows idly beat;
Resistance needs not their assaults to foil;
Shrinking into themselves, they straight recoil,
Leaving foam, dirt, and sea-weed at her feet.

On Douro's banks
Methinks I view the hostile, threatening ranks;
The Lord of war to battle calls:—
Hark! through the affrighted sky
Bursts the dread cannons' roar;
While thousand slaughterous balls
In volleys whizzing fly.
See, see, the Gallic Captain falls!
His bold achievements now are o'er.
The Britons shout, and rush into the field;
The French dishearten'd yield:
What heaps of wounded, slain,
O'er all the encumber'd plain!
They now resist no more.—
Hail Wellington!
The battle's won!
The voices of Renown the tidings spread:
Exulting England echoes thy applause;
Ambitious Gallia hears thy name with dread;
While European Freedom lifts her head,
And hails the great Defender of her cause.
Hero of England, with admiring eyes
We trace in thee the noble qualities
That constitute the Chief complete:
In others, oft, they singly shine;
In thee they all united meet,
And in one galaxy their rays combine.

Nature has given thee an intrepid heart,
That ever glows with patriotic flame,
And with the impassion'd love of martial fame.
And gifted, too, thou art

With a strong, hardy frame,
Patient of toils and hardships. In thy mind
Deep judgment with sagacity we find;
Coolness and firmness in rare union join'd.
In tactics versed, in all the rules of art,
By long experience taught, thou play'st the
Chieftain's part.

Lo, now! in vision rapt, I view
The far-famed plains of Waterloo.
As slowly, dimly dawns the morning-light,
Around the battle-field I cast my sight;
Thrill'd with delight severe, with awe oppress,
My labouring heart throbs wildly in my breast.
Hail fellow-countrymen! I trust in you,
And in your great Commander too;
Hail valiant Britons! hail brave Wellington!
Full many a conquest have ye gain'd;
O! may another, now, be soon obtain'd!
But yonder see the great Napoleon!
Secure of victory he proudly stands,
Surrounded by his choicest veteran bands,
Who welcome with loud shouts their long-loved
Chief,
From Elba's isle return'd, from exile brief;
They idolize him as the warrior-God,
And burn with zeal to obey his voice, his nod.
The opponent armies on each other gaze,
And look defiance though the view dismays.

Sudden the French artillery rends the skies;
And the Britannic instantly replies;
Hundreds of brazen throats shoot forth afar
Their iron globes, those thunderbolts of war;
Hundreds of soldiers fall upon the plain;
Some shot, expire; more, wounded, writhe in pain.
The cavalries to combat fiercely dash,

And like two comets 'gainst each other clash;
Horses and men roll mingled on the ground,
Confusion, slaughter, horror all around.
Regiments of infantry form quick the square,
And the fierce-charging horsemen firmly dare;
In vain to break them every means they try,
The troops well-disciplined, the attempts defy.
Long time in dread suspense the strife remains,
While heaps of dead and wounded load the plains.

Angel of Britain! guard our Hero's life!
On that, on that depends the upshot of the fight.
How does Napoleon's soul indignant burn!
Resolving, now, his last resource to try,
And urge his desperate way to victory,
He straight commands a vast, o'erpowering force
Of infantry, artillery, and horse,
The centre of his stubborn foe to turn.
Ah! now tremendous grows the strife,
On either side they war as Furies now;
What deluges of blood! what waste of life!
How will the mighty struggle finish?—how?—
Thank heaven! 'tis o'er,—the French, driven back,
retire;
Again I breathe—more freely I respire.
Lo! Bulow with the Prussian force appears!
The British Chief with joy his cannon hears,
And, flush'd with confidence, exulting cries,
We'll conquer yet; advance, my friends, advance!
Shouting they spring upon their enemies;
See, Wellington! the great Napoleon flies!—
Britannia, yet again, has triumph'd over France!

DESCRIPTION OF A CONFLAGRATION.

'Tis night:—the busy, ceaseless noise of
day
No more is heard; the now-deserted-
streets
Lie dark and silent;—London's weary
swarms
Rest in profound repose. Hark! a loud
cry
Frightens the silence;—'tis the cry of
fire!
I hear the dissonance of rattling wheels,
The tread of hasty feet, the doleful sigh
Of sympathy, and terror's thrilling
shriek:—
O mercy heaven!—

Behold the fiery Pest!
See, how the flames climb up the lofty
walls,
Involve their prey, and greedily devour:
The crowd exert their efforts to
controul
The spreading bane; some labour to
supply
The numerous engines; others bear
aloft
The pliant tubes, guiding their watery
store
Amid the fiercer fire; on ladders some
Ascending, scale the walls, and
undeterr'd,

Their dangerous office ply; some wildly
haste
To save their properties: 'tis bustle all,
And noisy tumult. Doubtful for a time
The strife remains; where'er the
Burning winds
His flamy spires, the well-directed
streams,
Incessant spouting, damp the sickening
flames,
Repelling their advance; but, oft
repulsed,
As oft they rally with recruited
strength:
Alternate in the mind rise hope and
fear.
Tumbles a roof with clattering noise,
the sky
Lightens, a burst of clamour!—all is
hush'd
In awful stillness, save that from
beneath
The ruins fall'n is heard a muttering
sound,
As if the Demon of the element
In indignation menaced dire revenge.
Ah! now, unchain'd by some mysterious
Power,
Some Fiend of air, in league with That
of fire,
The wind begins to howl; its breath
awakes
The sleepy flames;—loud and more
loud it howls,
And rushes on them with collected
might;

Before the driving spirit burst the
flames
In a redoubled tempest, and deride
Opposing man. See! how they proudly
toss
Their many heads on high, and through
the vault
Of darkness fling a sad, malignant day:
Look! with what fury, what resistless
rage,
From street to street the fiery Deluge
pours
His rapid billows, swallowing
everything
In horrible destruction; lowly roofs,
And gorgeous mansions, lofty spires
and domes
Capacious, on whose fair, majestic tops,
As on her throne exalted, Art assumed
Her noblest honours, whose firm pillars
braved
Storms, and the still-corroding course
of years;
These, these with all their wealth, the
various stores
Of luxury and commerce, to the flames
Abandon'd, sink an undefended prey,
Swelling the general wreck; unheeded
sink
By their possessors, flying for their
lives:
Cries, groans, laments, on every side
resound.

Sudden a magazine of nitrous grain
Bursts in a blazing column to the
clouds;

The dread explosion shakes the solid
ground,
And through the skies in lengthening
thunder rolls:
Driven by the furious overwhelming
blast
To distance round, the burning
fragments fall
On every side; see, see, yon ships catch
fire,
Their rigging's in a blaze; affrighted
Thames
Shrinks from the sight; his waters cast a
gleam
Portentous, dismal, like the light of
hell.

Before the Conflagration numbers fly
Frighted, in throngs precipitate, to seek
A refuge in the distant fields secure,
Which, cover'd thick with victims of
distress,
Present a wretched world. There Youth,
surprised
By hard experience, learns, alas! too
soon
The destiny of Man; and from those
eyes
Where expectation and unclouded joy
Serenely shone, the streams of sorrow
flow:
There helpless Age, robb'd of the scanty
means
A life of labour earn'd, driven from his
home
To wander, destitute, the vale of years,

Yields to despondence, tears his hoary
locks,
Falls on the ground, and eagerly
implores
Rest in the grave: there, gazing on the
fires,
The tender Mother stands,—her
frenzied soul
Glares from her look, her bosom heaves
a groan,
She hugs her crying infant to her heart,
Despairing, lost: what countless forms
of wo!
Lethargic some, and mute; some, giving
loose
To their distracted feelings, rave aloud
In all the clamorous vehemence of
grief.

The din subsides;—a voice, distinctly
heard,
A frantic voice exclaims, my child! my
child!
My child is in the flames!—Oh!
horrible!—
What succour? what resource? the
roaring wind
More fiercely blows, the Burning pours
along,
The skies are lighten'd, Uproar opens
wide
His thousand mouths, Danger and Ruin
prowl
At large with boundless license, all is
doubt
And consternation, one tempestuous
sea

Of wretchedness, one chaos of despair.

Seized with wild fear Imagination sees
The elements broke loose, Time on the
brink

Of dread Eternity, with all the signs
Of that tremendous period when the
dead

Shall rise to judgment—hush'd in
solemn awe—

Listening the trump of doom.—

Thus raged the
storm,

Till the great God of heaven in mercy
bade

The wind be silent, bade the gathering
clouds

Pour down abundant rain; the raging
Fires,

In prompt obedience to the sovereign
will

Of their Creator, dwindled and expired.

TO SPRING.

Fairest and loveliest of the sun-born train
That o'er the varying year alternate reign;
Whose eye, soft-beaming with thy father's fire,
Fond Nature woos with ever-fresh desire,
Enchanting Spring! O let thy votary's lay
Invite thy angel smile, thy genial sway!

Still do thy beauties, to my partial heart,
Whene'er I gaze, superior joys impart:
When winter's cloudy veil thou draw'st away }
And, vested with the sun's mild, dewy ray, }
First to the longing earth thy charms thou dost
display; }

Or when Aurora, to the lark's gay song,
Full of thy spirit, lightly trips along;
With joyful kisses greets the first-born flowers,
And o'er them breathes thy warm, refreshing
showers;

Or when, on shadowy pillow in the west,
Fann'd by thy gentlest Zephyrs into rest,
Eve sweetly dozes, whilst, as in a dream,
She sees the glimmerings of the solar beam
O'er the dim landscape languishingly stray,
On ocean's smiling face reflected play,
Fade in the purple ether's darkening hues,
And vernal peace and joy o'er earth diffuse.

More grateful strains, O Spring! thy favours claim,
Shine on thy beauties, and endear thy name.
While Winter's winds thy new-born charms deface,
And the young Year starves in his cold embrace,
The Hours, by stealth advancing, bear away,
And on thy lap, with smiles of pleasure, lay
The shivering Babe; new vigour there he gains,
And spreads thy various treasures o'er the plains.

The joyous Naiades, from their icy bands
Unfetter'd, dance and warble o'er the lands;
The Dryads feel thy genial breath, and raise
Their heads, new-crown'd with leaves, and whisper
praise;
The plummy warblers wake their amorous strains;
The herds and flocks sport o'er the fresh, green
plains;

Fancy and Hope return the mind to bless,
A paradise she sees and dreams of happiness.

Come, then, indulgent Ruler of the year,
Sweet Spring! to grateful Nature ever dear!
From the blest regions of Elysian day,
Climes favour'd high with thy perennial sway,
O deign to come! and let our raptured eyes
View thee, as through a veil, in these obscurer skies.

Methinks, I see thee coming from afar,
Thy beauty decks Apollo's mounting car;
The tyrant of the north with dazzled sight
Beholds, and, yielding, meditates his flight;
His dread, petrific rod he long has broke,
And freed glad Nature from his icy yoke;
She lifts her head, and hails the approaching hour
When she shall feel thy more propitious power.

O haste thy progress, and exert thy sway!
In all thy charms, on some thrice-hallow'd day,
When the soft-whispering air to Fancy's ears
Wafts the celestial music of the spheres,
While Pleasures, Loves, and Graces round thee fly,
Glide on a sun-beam down the clear, blue sky;
Crown'd with a myrtle-wreath, begin thy reign;
Bid lingering Winter fly with all his train;
Pour forth thy favours o'er this western isle,
And let each grateful eye reflect thy smile.

TO WINTER.

No longer Beauty's many-colour'd robe

Adorns the autumnal scene; no longer
play
The Zephyrs with her tresses; she has
fled
To happier regions, and has left the year
Naked and void of charms; the leafless
woods
Tremble no more with rapture at the
voice
Of harmony: ah! how is Nature
changed!
Silent, and sad, she anxiously awaits
Thy coming, mighty King! and, as the
sun
Less bright, less ardent, more and more
declines
Towards the horizon, with alarm she
marks
Thy shadow lengthening in the nightly
shade
And towering o'er her, prostrate as she
lies,
More threatening, more gigantic; till, at
length,
Boreas, thy harbinger, forth-rushing
fierce,
Tears from chill'd Autumn's head the
withering Crown,
And blustering loud in her affrighted
ear,
O Winter! tells thy terrible approach.

Behold! in awful majesty thou comest!
On huge, black clouds, that through the
encumber'd sky,
Before the northern blast, sail slowly
on,

Thou ridest sublime; aloft in ether
towers
Thy giant form; thy formidable frown
Blackens the night; thy threatening
voice, sent forth
Upon the impetuous winds, affrights
the world.
Yet dare I welcome thee, terrific Power!
Dread Winter, hail! thy terrors fill my
soul
With a delightful awe; I love to trace
Thy varying scenes, the wonders of thy
reign.
Thy Ministers await thy sovereign will,
And, in the secret regions of the air,
In cloudy magazines prepare thy stores
Of snow, and rain, and hail. At thy
command
Frost, that invisible, mysterious Power,
Breathes upon Nature, and thou see'st
her soon
An unresisting captive, bound in ice;
Vainly she mourns, till, at thy bidding,
Thaw
With his damp, misty standard, from
the south
Comes creeping silently, and sets her
free;
She weeps for joy. Ah! now thou dost
unchain
The Demon of the tempest, to exert
On tortured Nature thy tyrannic might;
Fierce on the whirlwind's wing he
rushes forth
With dreadful bellowings, hurling all
around
Destructive deluges of rain, snow, hail,

In wildest discord, and chaotic war
Mingling earth, sea, and sky. All-potent
Lord!

Dread Winter! though Sublimity
appears

Thy chief attendant, and partakes thy
throne;

Yet Beauty often visits thee, and dares,
In many a scene, with the more
powerful charms

Of her majestic sister to combine
Her pleasing graces: I delight to view
Thy snowy robe of purest, glowing
white,

The clear, blue skies, the cheerful
evergreen

Amid the wintry desert, from whose
boughs

The little redbreast chirps; the trees and
herbs

With snow and hoarfrost fringed, to
fancy's eye

Presenting pictured shapes, and, when
the sun

Sheds o'er them his effulgence,
sparkling keen

With million living particles of light.

But with far nobler transport I survey
Thy nightly scene, O Winter! when by
frost

Refined and clear'd, the pure
transpicuous air

Through her thin, azure veil, to
wondering man

Displays the unclouded heavens,
myriads of stars

Shining in all their glory: at the view
Rapt Contemplation, in her car of light,
Expatriates in the interminable space,
Ranging from world to world, from sun
to sun,
O'erwhelm'd with wonder and
astonishment,
And sacred awe, till lifting up her eyes,
She sees Religion, from the opening
gate
Of heaven itself, on her seraphic wings
Smiling descend; she feels her power
divine,
And raptured hymns the great Creator's
praise.

THE DESPERATION AND MADNESS OF GUILT.

In depth of loneliest wood, amid the din
Of midnight storm and thunder, spoke Despair,
While Horror, shuddering, heard that voice alone.
Oh! load of guilt! relentless misery!
Still, ever still the same where'er I fly;
No peace, no hope, not one poor moment's glimpse
Through all the blackness of eternity!
Monster of direst guilt! this mother's hand
Murder'd my babe, my new-born innocent.
I seek not mercy, no!—long sought in vain
While conscience prey'd upon my secret heart,
Wasting its life in agonizing groans,
And floods of scalding tears,—but now no more;

Those pangs are past, this heart is wither'd, dead!
Changed all to crime, all rottenness and stench;
'Twould taint creation were it not confined.
Parch'd are these eyes, their sorrows turn'd to ice,
A mountain of impenetrable ice,
In whose unfathom'd centre lies my soul,
Imprison'd, numb'd, buried in conscious death.
O could I cease to think! cease quite to be!
O could I live in torments! writhe in hell!
Raptures to this! Rouse, rouse to life, my soul,
In madness of despair, O burst thy tomb;
Call God and devils to behold thy guilt,
And blast thee. (*It lightens.*)

See, what sudden blaze! they come!
Welcome, O welcome! follow me, look there!
There lies my murder'd babe:—now strike!—avenge!
(*It thunders.*)

Overwhelming stroke!
(*She falls upon the ground insensible:—
at length, coming to herself*)—

Ah! am I conscious still?
Not blasted then?—does this one little spark
Amidst a universe of solid gloom
Still live? I'll try to quench it with my blood.
Come, dagger, pierce, pierce deep; I feel thy point;
My blood flows fast, it animates my heart.
The gathering cloud of death grows thick and dark,
It hangs oppressive on my swimming sight:
See, see, the Spirit of my murder'd child
Comes with a troop of demons to conduct
My soul to hell;—they seize me for their prey,
They drag me down: Oh! horror! horror! oh!
(*She dies.*)

ON HEARING THE NIGHTINGALE.

Thanks for thy song, sweet Bird! thanks
for thy song!

O! 'twas delightful; how have I been
lost

As in a blissful dream! how has my
soul

Been wafted in a sea of melody!
Scarce yet am I awake, yet scarce
myself:

Still with the enchanting music's dying
breath

The air is kept in motion, and conveys
Sweet whispers to the finely-listening
ear;

Or is it but an echo from the cell
Of memory that deludes my doating
sense?

Ah! now 'tis gone; Silence resumes her
sway,

And o'er my hearing spreads her subtile
web;

But she resumes it, changed, methinks,
in nature,

More soft, more amiable, as if inform'd
With the departed soul of harmony.

Thanks for thy song, sweet Bird! it well
deserves

All my heart's gratitude; for it has still'd
Its anxious throbbings, and removed the
load

Of sadness that oppress'd the springs of
life:

More lightly now it beats, and
welcomes back

The glowing tide of health, and
conscious feels

The blessing of existence. It imparts
To all my frame reanimating force;
My nerves partake of its elastic spring;
No longer falsely sentient, they receive
The just impression from external
things,

Vibrate harmoniously to Nature's touch,
And in her general concert bear a part.

Thanks, sweetest Bird! enchanting
Nightingale!

How by the magic influence of thy
song,

How am I changed from what, of late, I
was!

And every object, too, how seems it
changed!

This wood, when first I enter'd it,
appear'd

To Fancy's eye the haunt of
Melancholy,

Her dreariest haunt, where, in her
saddest mood,

The Goddess loved to dwell;—'twas
lonesome gloom,

And awful stillness all: I felt her power;
The imaginative Spirit she o'erwhelm'd
With a mysterious load of shapeless
feeling:

Her leaden hand oppress'd my
labouring heart;

Upon the ground I sank,—scarce
sensible,
And buried, as it were, in conscious
death.

With what soft influence, what
resistless power,
Did thy mellifluous strain, kind
Philomel!
Insinuate itself into my ear,
Melting its dull unwillingness to listen,
And opening soon a passage to my
heart!
But thou beginn'st again, be hush'd my
soul!
O wondrous power of heavenly
harmony!
See, Philomel! the Goddess of the
night,
Charm'd with thy strains her cloudy veil
withdraws,
And pays thee with a smile of gratitude;
A smile that to her beauty adds new
charms,
Enchanting heaven and earth, while
Melancholy,
Sighing away her sadness, lifts her
head,
And, gazing on her tutelary Power
With eyes reflecting soft her dewy
light,
Feels her divinest inspiration steal
Into her melting soul, absorb'd in
heaven.
My sympathizing heart with bliss
o'erflows.

Thanks sweetest Nightingale! thanks
for thy song!
Long on this night shall grateful
memory doat;
And oft to this loved wood will I return.

TO PAGANINI.

Long to the world have all the mouths
of Fame,
O Paganini! thunder'd forth thy name;
Nations have vied their plausible voice
to raise,
And swell the general chorus of thy
praise.
Though not so loud, more dear the
applause to thee
Of all the favour'd sons of harmony,
Who, with one full consent, admiring
own}
Thee as their master—monarch—thee
alone;}
And humbly bow before thee on thy
throne.}

O'er all musicians thou stand'st far
apart;
Thou hast created for thyself an art.
As, in the natural world, around the sun
The planets their career of brightness
run,
Each moving in an orbit of its own,
And all obeying laws to science known.

Musicians thus, each blest with his
degree
Of talent by the God of harmony,
Shine forth distinguish'd in their several
ways,
While every one the rules of art obeys.
We calculate the merits of their name,
And pay them their proportion'd share
of fame.
Not thus in Honour's region thou
career'st;
Thou comet-like to fancy's ken
appear'st,
Like comet, blazing in its bold career,
That leaves behind the planetary
sphere,
And rushes towards the centre of the
sun
Till with Apollo's self it seems but one.

A Genius, an Original, art thou,
Such as the astounded world ne'er heard
till now.
When thou dost take thy magic bow in
hand
What mortal ear the enchantment can
withstand?
Transported, we admire thy peerless
skill;
Thou movest our feelings, passions, at
thy will;
With fear we tremble, we with anger
glow,
Soft from our eyes the tears of pity
flow;
Or when thou play'st a gay, fantastic
strain,

From mirth and laughter who can then
 refrain?
Such is thy music's power to rule the
 heart,
Thou may'st be call'd the Shakspeare of
 thine art.

TO FANCY.

O! what a nameless feeling of delight
Stole o'er my wondering spirit, like a
 gleam
From opening heaven!—dost thou,
 then, Fancy, deign
Once more to visit me? thou dost! thou
 dost!
That breath of extacy, that heavenly
 light,
Flow'd from the wafture of thy angel
 wings,
And from thy smiling eyes: divinest
 Power!
Welcome, thrice welcome! O vouchsafe
 to make
My breast thy temple, and my heart thy
 shrine!
Still will I worship thee, and thou shalt
 keep,
In peace, thy new abode, nor fear the
 approach
Of aught profane or hostile, to disturb
Thy holy mysteries; for I will chase

Far from the hallow'd precincts where
 thou dwell'st
Each worldly passion, every grovelling
 thought,
And all the train of Vice; striving to
 make
The shrine well-worthy its celestial
 guest.
Still will I worship thee, and oft invoke
Thine inspirations, and with transport
 yield
To thy sweet, magic influence all my
 soul:
The slightest breath of thine inspiring
 voice
Shall wake my nerves, most feelingly
 alive,
And bid them tremble with poetic bliss.

The frown of Reason thou no more
 shalt fear;
Did I say Reason's frown?—no!—'twas
 the frown
Of false Philosophy, her foolish pride.
Reason and Thou are sisters, born to
 rule
Unitedly, in happiest harmony,
The mind of man; and in the heaven-
 sent hour
Of inspiration, from the self-same
 source
Ye pour the stream of mingled light and
 flame
That animates, illumines, and warms the
 soul.
How could I e'er desert thee, loveliest
 Nymph!

To court thy rival, false Philosophy?
How could I quit thy verdant, flowery
walks,
To tread with painful toil the briary
maze
Of metaphysic lore? Indulgent Power!
The offence forgive. Lured by the
specious name,
Philosophy, and by her meteor rays
Misled, with fond presumptuousness I
strove
To penetrate the dark, unfathom'd depth
Where Truth in awful mystery resides.
Not deigning in thy mirror to behold
Her image, though in loveliest beauty
clad,
With lawless curiosity I sought
To view the Goddess in her naked form.
But heaven to man, nor angel gives to
scan
Truth's very self; she lives for ever hid,
Shrined in the bosom of Divinity.
Long wandering mid the chaos, I at
length
Approach'd the border of the cold, dark
waste,
The bottomless abyss, the dreadful void
Of scepticism; affrighted, back I
shrunk.

O Fancy! ne'er will I forsake thee more,
Nor view thee with severe, truth-
searching eye,
Melting thy fairy visions into air.
Thy paradise, delighted, let me rove,
There study nature, and with grateful
heart,

In thy serene, translucent stream behold
The light of truth reflected, and the
 smile
Of heaven's benevolence, and in that
 glass
The loveliness of every Virtue woo
And every Grace. There let me, too,
 behold
In all her beauty, bright-eyed Poesy,
That heavenly Maid who charm'd my
 youthful heart;
And let the love of glory fire my breast;
And let me see, to stimulate my
 powers,
The new-born crescent of my fame
 ascend,
While on its pointed horn the Fairy,
 Hope,
On tiptoe stands, fluttering her airy
 wings
To fan its beams and joyful hails the
 hour
When in its full-orb'd glory it shall
 shine.

A SUMMER-EVENING.

Come, my dear Love, and let us climb
 yon hill,
The prospect, from its height, will well
 reward
The toil of climbing; thence we shall
 command

The various beauties of the landscape
round.—
Now we have reached the top. O! what
a scene
Opens upon the sight, and swallows up
The admiring soul! She feels as if from
earth
Uplifted into heaven. Scarce can she
yet
Collect herself, and exercise her
powers.
While o'er heaven's lofty, wide-
extended arch,
And round the vast horizon, the bold
eye
Shoots forth her view, with what
sublime delight
The bosom swells! See, where the God
of day,
Who through the cloudless ether long
has rid
On his bright, fiery car, amidst a blaze
Of dazzling glory, and in wrath shot
round
His burning arrows, with tyrannic
power
Oppressing Nature, now, his daily
course
Well-nigh completed, toward the
western goal
Declines, and with less awful majesty
Concludes his reign; his flamy chariot
hid
In floods of golden light that dazzles
still,
Though less intense. O! how these
scenes exalt

The throbbing heart! Louisa, canst thou
bear
These strong emotions? do they not
o'erpower
Thy tender nerves? I fear, my Love,
they do;
Those eyes that, late, with transport
beam'd so bright,
Now veil their rays with the soft, dewy
shade
Of tenderness. Let us repose awhile;
The roots of yonder tree, cover'd with
moss,
Present a pleasing seat; there let us sit.
Hark! Zephyr wakes, and sweetly-
whispering, tells
The approach of Eve; already Nature
feels
Her soothing influence, her refreshing
breath;
The fields, the trees, imbibe the cool,
moist air,
Their feverish thirst allay, and smile
revived.
The Soul, too, feels her influence,
sweetly soothed
Into a tender calm. O! let us now,
My loved Louisa! let us now enjoy
The landscape's charms, and all the
nameless sweets
Of this, our favourite hour, for ever
dear
To Fancy and to Love. Cast round thy
sight
Upon the altered scene, nor longer fear
The dazzling sun; his latest, lingering
beams

Where are they? can'st thou find them?
—see! they gild
The glittering top of yonder village-
spire;
Upon that distant hill they faintly shine;
And look! the topmost boughs of this
tall oak
Majestic, which o'ercanopies our heads,
Yet catch their tremulous glimmerings:
—now they fade,
Fade and expire; and, as they fade, the
Moon,
The full-orb'd Moon, that seem'd,
erewhile, to melt
In the bright azure, from the darkening
sky
Emerging slow, and silent, sheds
around
Her snowy light, that with the day's
last, dim
Reflection, from the broad, translucent
lake,
Insensibly commingles, and unites
In sweetest harmony, o'er all the scene
Diffusing magic tints, enchanting
power.
How lovely every object now appears!
Each in itself, and how they all
combine
In one delightful whole! What eye,
what heart,
O Nature! can resist thy potent charms
When thus in soft, transparent shade
half-veil'd?
Now Beauty and Sublimity, methinks,
Upon the lap of Eve, embracing sleep.

Mark the tree-tops, my Love, of yonder
wood,
Whose moonlight foliage fluctuates in
the breeze,
Say, do they not, in figure, motion, hue,
Resemble the sea-waves at misty
dawn?
What shadowy shape along the troubled
lake
Comes this way moving? how
mysteriously
It glides along! how indistinct its form!
Imagination views with sweet surprise
The unknown appearance—breathless
in suspense.
The Spirit of the waters can it be,
On his aerial car? some fairy Power?
Pants not thy heart, Louisa, half-
alarm'd?
It grows upon the sight,—strange,
watery sounds
Attend its course;—hark! was not that a
voice?
O! 'tis a fishing-boat!—its sails and
oars
I now discern. The church-clock
strikes! how loud
Burst forth its sound into the startled
air,
That feels it still, and trembles far
around!
My dearest Love! it summons us away;
The dew begins to fall; let us depart:
How sweetly have we spent this
evening-hour!

PROLOGUE.

The piece, to-night, is of peculiar kind,
For which the appropriate name is hard
to find;
No Comedy, 'tis clear; nor can it be,
With strictest truth, pronounced a
Tragedy;
Since, though predominant the tragic
tone,
It reigns not uniformly and alone;
Then, that its character be best
proclaim'd,
A Tragic-drama let the piece be named.

But do not, Critics! rashly hence
conclude,
'Tis a mere Farce, incongruous and
rude,
Where incidents in strange confusion
blend,
Without connexion, interest, or end:
Not so;—far different was the bard's
design;
For though, at times, he ventures to
combine
With grave Melpomene's impassion'd
strain
The gay Thalia's more enlivening vein;
(As all mankind with one consent agree
How strong the charms of sweet
variety,)
Yet Reason's path he still with care
observes,

And ne'er from Taste with wilful
 blindness swerves,
His plot conducting by the rules of art:
And, above all, he strives to touch the
 heart;
Knowing that, void of pathos and of
 fire,
Art, Reason, Taste, are vain, and
 quickly tire.

Be mindful then, ye Critics! of the
 intent;
The poet means not here to represent
The tragic Muse in all her terrors drest,
With might tempestuous to convulse
 the breast;
Nor in her statelier, unrelaxing mien,
To stalk, in buskin'd pomp, through
 every scene;
But with an air more mild and
 versatile, }
Where fear and grief, sometimes, admit
 a smile, }
Now loftier, humbler now, the changing
 style, }
Resembling in effect an April-night
When from the clouds, by fits, the
 moon throws forth her light;
And louder winds, by turns, their rage
 appease,
Succeeded by the simply-whispering
 breeze.

But, in few words our author ends his
 plea,
Already tending to prolixity,

To paint from Nature was his leading
aim;
Let then, the play your candid hearing
claim:
Judge it, impartial, by dramatic laws;
If good, reward it with deserved
applause;
If bad, condemn; yet be it still exempt
From your severer blame, for 'tis a first
attempt.

PROLOGUE.

Lo! Time, at last, has brought, with
tardy flight,
The long-anticipated, wish'd-for night;
How on this blissful night, while yet
remote,
Did Hope and Fancy with fond rapture
doat!
Like eagles, oft, in glory's dazzling sky,
With full-stretch'd pinions have they
soar'd on high,
To greet the appearance of the poet's
name,
Dawning conspicuous mid the stars of
fame.

Alas! they soar not now;—the demon,
Fear,
Has hurl'd the cherubs from their
heavenly sphere:

Fancy, o'erwhelm'd with terror,
 grovelling lies;—
The world of torment opens on her
 eyes,
Darkness and hissing all she sees and
 hears;—
 (The speaker pauses—the
 audience are
 supposed to clap, when he
 continues,)
But Hope, returning to dispel her fears,
Claps her bright wings; the magic
 sound and light
At once have forced their dreaded foe
 to flight,
Silenced the hissing, chased the
 darkness round,
And charm'd up marvelling Fancy from
 the ground.

Say, shall the cherubs dare once more
 to fly?
Not, as of late, in glory's dazzling sky,
To greet the appearance of the poet's
 name,
Dawning conspicuous mid the stars of
 fame;
Presumptuous flight! but let them dare
 to rise,
Cheer'd by the light of your propitious
 eyes,
Within this roof, glory's contracted
 sphere,
On fluttering pinions, unsubdued by
 Fear;
O! let them dare, ere yet the curtain
 draws,

Fondly anticipate your kind applause.

EPILOGUE.

Perplexing case!—your pardon,
 Friends, I pray,—
My head so turns, I know not what to
 say;—
However, since I've dared to come
 before ye,
I'll stop the whirligig,—
 (*Clapping his hand to his
 forehead,*)
 and tell my story:
Though 'tis so strange, that I've a pre-
 conviction
It may by some, perhaps, be judged a
 fiction.

Learn, gentle Audience, then, with just
 surprise,
That, when, to-night, you saw the
 curtain rise,
Our poet's epilogue was still unwrit:
The devil take him for neglecting it!
Nay though,—'twas not neglected;
 'twas deferr'd
From certain motives—which were
 most absurd;
For, trusting blindly to his rhyming
 vein,
And still-prepared inventiveness of
 brain,

He'd form'd the whimsical, foolhardy
plan,
To set about it when the play began;
Thus purposing the drama's fate to
know,
Then write his epilogue quite à propos.

The time at last arrives—the signal
rings,
Sir Bard, alarm'd, to pen and paper
springs,
And, snug in listening-corner, near the
scene,
With open'd ears, eyes, mouth-
suspended mien,—
Watches opinion's breezes as they blow,
To kindle fancy's fire, and bid his
verses flow.

Now I, kind Auditors! by fortune's spite
Was doom'd, alack! to speak what he
should write,
And therefore, as you'll naturally
suppose,
Could not forbear, at times, to cock my
nose
Over his shoulder, curiously to trace
His progress;—zounds! how snail-like
was his pace!
Feeling, at length, my sore-tried
patience sicken,
Good Sir, I cried, your tardy motions
quicken:
'Tis the fourth act, high time, Sir, to
have done!
As if his ear had been the touch-hole of
a gun,

My tongue a match, the Bard, on fire,
 exploded;
He was—excuse the pun—with grape
 high-loaded.
Hence, prating fool! return'd he, in a
 roar,
Push'd me out, neck and heels, and
 bang'd the door.

But lest, here too, like hazard I should
 run;}
I'll end my story. When the play was
 done,}
The epilogue was—look! 'tis here—
 begun:}
Such as it is, however, if you will,
I'll read it; shall I, Friends?
 (*They clap.*)

 Your orders I
 fulfil.
 (*He reads.*)

'Tis come! the fateful hour! list! list! the
 bell
Summons me—Duncan-like, to heaven
 or hell;
See, see, the curtain draws;—it now
 commences;
Fear and suspense have frozen up my
 senses:
But let me to my task:—what noise is
 this?
They're clapping, clapping, O ye gods,
 what bliss!
Now then, to work, my pen:—descend,
 O Muse!
Thine inspiration through my soul
 infuse;

Prompt such an epilogue as ne'er before
Has been imagined,—never will be
more.

What subject? hark! new louder
plaudits rise,
I'm fired, and, like a rocket, to the skies
Dart up triumphantly in flames of light:
—

They hiss, I'm quench'd, and sink in
shades of night.
Again they clap, O extacy!—
Having thus far indulged his rhyming
vein,
He halts,—reads,—curses,—and begins
again;
But not a single couplet could he
muster;
How should he, with his soul in such a
fluster,
All rapture, gratitude, for your
applause?
Be then, the effect excused in favour of
the cause!

LINES

ON THE DEATH OF THE REV. MR. B.

(SUPPOSED TO BE WRITTEN BY MISS B***, HIS SISTER.)

At God's command the vital spirit fled,
And thou, my Brother! slumber'st with
the dead.

Alas! how art thou changed! I scarcely
dare

To gaze on thee;—dread sight! death,
death is there.

How does thy loss o'erwhelm my heart
with grief!

But tears, kind nature's tears afford
relief.

Reluctant, sad, I take my last farewell:

—

Thy virtues in my mind shall ever
dwell;

Thy tender friendship felt so long for
me,

Thy frankness, truth, thy generosity,
Thy tuneful tongue's persuasive
eloquence,

Thy science, learning, taste, wit,
common sense,

Thy patriot love of genuine liberty,
Thy heart o'erflowing with
philanthropy;

And chiefly will I strive henceforth to
feel

Thy firm religious faith and pious zeal,
Enlighten'd, liberal, free from bigotry,
And, that prime excellence, thy charity.

Farewell!—for ever?—no! forbid it,
Heaven!

A glorious promise is to Christians
given;

Though parted in this world of sin and
pain,

On high, my Brother! we shall meet
again.

LINES TO AN INFIDEL,

**AFTER HAVING READ HIS BOOK AGAINST
CHRISTIANITY.**

Your book I've read: I would that I had
not!
For what instruction, pleasure, have I
got?
Amid that artful labyrinth of doubt
Long, long I wander'd, striving to get
out;
Your thread of sophistry, my only clue,
I fondly hoped would guide me rightly
through:
That spider's web entangled me the
more:
With desperate courage onward still I
went,
Until my head was turn'd, my patience
spent:
Now, now, at last, thank God! the task
is o'er.
I've been a child, who whirls himself
about,
Fancying he sees both earth and heaven
turn round;
Till giddy, panting, sick, and wearied
out,

He falls, and rues his folly on the
ground.

LINES

ON HEARING A YOUNG GENTLEMAN, WHO IS BOTH
LAME
AND BLIND, BUT IN OTHER RESPECTS VERY
HANDSOME,
SING AND PLAY ON HIS VIOLIN FOR THE FIRST TIME.

Crippled his limbs, and sightless are his
eyes;
I view the youth, and feel compassion
rise.
He sings! how sweet the notes! in
pleased amaze
I listen,—listen, and admiring gaze.
Still, as he catches inspiration's fire,
Sweeping with bolder hands the
obedient strings,
That mix, harmonious, with the strains
he sings,
He pours into the music all his soul,
And governs mine with strong, but soft
controul:
Raptured I glow, and more and more
admire.
His mortal ailments I no longer see;
But, of divinities my fancy dreams;
Blind was the enchanting God of soft
desire;

And lame the powerful Deity of fire;
His bow the magic rod of Hermes
seems;
And in his voice I hear the God of
harmony.

LINES TO A PEDANTIC CRITIC.

Critic! should I vouchsafe to learn of
thee,
Correct, no doubt, but cold my strains
would be:
Now, cold correctness!—I despise the
name;
Is that a passport through the gates of
fame?
Thy pedant rules with care I studied
once;
Was I made wiser, or a greater dunce?
Hence, Critic, hence! I'll study them no
more;
My eyes are open'd, and the folly's o'er.
When Genius opes the floodgates of the
soul,
Fancy's outbursting tides impetuous
roll,
Onward they rush with unresisted
sway,}
Sweeping fools, pedants, critics, all
away}
Who would with obstacles their
progress stay.}

As mighty Ocean bids his waves
comply
With the great luminaries of the sky,
So Genius, to direct his course aright,
Owns but one guide, the inspiring God
of light.

LINES ON SHAKSPEARE.

(SUPPOSED TO BE WRITTEN NEAR HIS TOMB.)

Behold! this marble tablet bears
inscribed
The name of Shakspeare!—
What a glorious
theme
For never-ending praise! His drama's
page,
Like a clear mirror, to our wondering
view
Displays the living image of the world,
And all the different characters of men:
Still, in the varying scenes, or sad, or
gay,
We take a part; we weep; we laugh; we
feel
All the strong sympathies of real life.
To him alone, of mortals, Fancy lent
Her magic wand, potent to conjure up
Ideal Forms, distinctly character'd,
Exciting fear, or wonder, or delight.

The works of Shakspeare! are they not
a fane,
Majestic as the canopy of heaven,
Embracing all created things, a fane
His superhuman genius has upraised,
To Nature consecrate? The Goddess
there
For ever dwells, and from her
sanctuary,
By Shakspeare's voice, her poet and
high-priest,
Reveals her awful mysteries to man,
And with her power divine rules every
heart.
At Shakspeare's name, then, bow down
all ye sons
Of learning, and of art! ye men,
endow'd
With talent, taste! ye nobler few who
feel
The genuine glow of genius! bow down
all
In admiration! with deep feeling own
Your littleness, your insignificance;
And with one general voice due
homage pay
To Nature's Poet, Fancy's best-loved
Child!

LINES ON MILTON.

(SUPPOSED TO BE WRITTEN NEAR HIS TOMB.)

Milton!—

the name of that divinest
Bard
Acts on Imagination like a charm
Of holiest power;—with deep, religious
awe
She hails the sacred spot where sleep
entomb'd
The relics that enshrined his godlike
soul.

O! with what heartfelt interest and
delight,
With what astonishment, will all the
sons
Of Adam, till the end of time, peruse
His lofty, wondrous page! with what
just pride
Will England ever boast her Milton's
name,
The Poet matchless in sublimity!
E'en now in Memory's raptured ear
resound
The deep-toned strains of the Miltonic
lyre;
Inspiring virtuous, heart-ennobling
thought,
They breathe of heaven; the
imaginative Power
No longer treads the guilt-polluted
world,
But soars aloft, and draws empyreal air:

Rapt Faith anticipates the judgment-
hour,
When, at the Archangel's call, the dead
shall wake
With frames resuscitated, glorified:
Then, then! in strains like these, the
sainted Bard,
Conspicuous mid salvation's earth-born
heirs,
Shall join harmoniously the heavenly
choir,
And sing the Saviour's praise in endless
bliss.

ANACREONTIC.

Still, as the fleeting seasons change,
From joy to joy poor mortals range,
And as the year pursues its round,
One pleasure's lost, another found;
Time, urging on his envious course,
Still drives them from their last
resource.

So butterflies, when children chase
The gaudy prize with eager pace,
On each fresh flower but just alight,
And, ere they taste, renew their flight.

Thanks to kind Fortune! I possess
A constant source of happiness,
And am not poorly forced to live
On what the seasons please to give.

Let clouds or sunshine vest the pole,
What care I, while I quaff the bowl?
In that secure, I can defy
The changeful temper of the sky.
No weatherglass, or if I be,
Thou, Bacchus! art my Mercury.

ANACREONTIC.

Let us, my Friends, our mirth forbear,
While yonder Censor mounts the chair:
His form erect, his stately pace,
His huge, white wig, his solemn face,
His scowling brows, his ken severe,
His haughty pleasure-chiding sneer,
Some high Philosopher declare:—
Hush! let us hear him from the chair:

'Ye giddy youths! I hate your mirth;
How ill-beseeming sons of earth!
Know ye not well the fate of man?
That death is certain, life a span?
That merriment soon sinks in sorrow,
Sunshine to-day, and clouds to-
morrow?
Hearken then, fools! to Reason's voice,
That bids ye mourn, and not rejoice?'

Such gloomy thoughts, grave Sage! are
thine,
Now, gentle Friends! attend to mine.
Since mortals must die,
Since life's but a span,

'Tis wisdom, say I,
To live while we can,
And fill up with pleasure
The poor little measure.
Of fate to complain
How simple and vain!
Long faces I hate;
They shorten the date.
My Friends! while ye may,
Be jovial to-day;
The things that will be
Ne'er wish to foresee;
Or, should ye employ
Your thoughts on to-morrow,
Let Hope sing of joy,
Not Fear croak of sorrow.
But see! the Sage flies, so no more.
Now, Friends! drink and sing, as before.

ANACREONTIC.

Why must Poets, when they sing,
Drink of the Castalian spring?
Sure 'tis chilling to the brain;
Witness many a modern strain:
Poets! would ye sing with fire,
Wine, not water, must inspire.
Come, then, pour thy purple stream,
Lovely Bottle! thou'rt my theme.
How within thy crystal frame
Does the rosy nectar flame!
Not so beauteous on the vine

Did the clustering rubies shine,
When the potent God of day
Fill'd them with his ripening ray;
When with proudness and delight
Bacchus view'd the charming sight.
Still it keeps Apollo's fires;
Still the vintage-God admires.
Hail sweet antidote of wo!
Chiefest blessing mortals know!
Nay, the mighty powers divine
Own the magic force of wine.
Wearied with the world's affairs,
Jove himself, to drown his cares,
Bids the nectar'd goblet bear:
Lo! the youthful Hebe fair
Pours the living draught around;—
Hark! with mirth the skies resound.
'Tis to wine, for aught I know,
Deities their godship owe;
Don't we mortals owe to wine
Manhood, and each spark divine?
Say, thou life-inspiring Bowl,
Who thy heavenly treasure stole?
Not the hand that stole Jove's fire
Did so happily aspire;
Tell the lucky spoiler's name,
Worthy never-dying fame.
Since it must a secret be,
Him I'll praise, in praising thee.
Glory of the social treat!
Source of friendly converse sweet!
Source of cheerfulness and sense,
Humour, wit, and eloquence,
Courage and sincerity,
Candour and philanthropy!
Source of—O thou bounteous wine!
What the good that is not thine?

Were my nerves relax'd and low?
Did my chill blood toil on slow?
When thy spirit through me flows,
How each vital function glows!
Tuned, my nerves, no longer coy,
Answer to the touch of joy:
On the steams, that from thee rise,
Time on swifter pinions flies;
Fancy gilds them with her rays;
Hope amid the rainbow plays.
But behold! what Image bright
Rises heavenly to my sight!
Could such wondrous charms adorn
Venus, when from ocean born?
Say, my Julia, is it thou,
Ever lovely, loveliest now?
Yet, methinks, the Cyprian Queen
Comes herself, but takes thy mien.
Goddess! I confess thy power,
And to love devote the hour,
Let me but, with grateful soul,
Greet once more the bounteous Bowl.

SONG.

Ere Reason rose within my breast,
To enforce her sacred law,
Still would some charm, in every maid,
My veering passions draw.

But now, to calm those gales of night,
The morn her light displays;
The twinkling stars no more I view,

For only Venus sways:

The spotless heaven of genuine love
Unveil'd I wondering see,
And all that heaven, transported, claim
For Julia and for me.

SONG.

Yes, I could love, could softly yield
To passion all my willing breast,
And fondly listen to the voice
That oft invites me to be blest;

That still, when Fancy, lost in bliss,
Stands gazing on the form divine,
So sweetly whispers to my soul,
O make the heavenly Julia thine!

But hush, thou fascinating voice!
Hence visionary extacy!
Yes, I could love, but ah! I fear
She would not deign to smile on me.

SONG TO BACCHUS.

Come along, jolly Bacchus! no longer delay;

See'st thou not how the table with bottles is
crown'd?

See'st thou not how thy votaries, impatient to pay
Their devotion to thee, are all waiting around?
O come then, propitious to our invocation,
To preside of thy rites at the solemnization.

Hark! the voice of Champagne, from its prison set
free,
And the music of glasses that merrily ring,
Thy arrival announce, and invite us to glee;
With what gladness we welcome thee, vine-crowned
King!
To honour thee, Bacchus! we pour a libation,
And the lofty roof echoes our loud salutation.

On that wine-loaded altar, erected to thee,
Sherry, burgundy, claret, invitingly shine;
While all thy rich gifts thus collected we see,
We greet thy munificence boundless, divine.
From these we already inhale animation,
Our hearts and heads warmth, and our souls
elevation.

As thy nectar, kind Bacchus! more copiously flows,
We purge off the cold dregs that are earthy, profane;
Each breast with thy own godlike character glows;
There truth, generosity, happiness reign.
Hail Bacchus! we hail thee in high exultation;
Thou hast blest us, kind God! with thy full
inspiration.

ON SEEING THE APOLLO BELVIDERE.

What majesty! what elegance and
grace!
The form how perfect! how divine the
face!
In admiration rapt, I gazing stand:—
Is this a statue wrought by mortal hand?
No! 'tis Apollo's self, methinks I see;
I feel the presence of the Deity.

INSCRIPTION FOR THE APOLLO BELVIDERE.

O all ye Sons of Taste! with raptured
sight
Behold this image of the God of light;
Admire its whole, admire its every part;
'Tis sculpture's master-work, the boast
of Art.
Not with more glory in his heavenly
sphere
The God appears, than in his Image
here.

EPITAPH ON NELSON.

Lo! here are Nelson's honour'd relics
laid;—

Britons! your Country's Genius calls
you here,
And bids you pay to your lost Hero's
shade
The noble homage of a patriot tear.

Against the fleets of Gallia, Denmark,
Spain,
Full oft Britannia's war-bolts he has
hurl'd;
Stretch'd forth her sceptre o'er the
vanquish'd main,
And with her glory fill'd the astonish'd
world.

His matchless triumphs shall the voice
of Fame,
With loud applause, to latest ages tell;
Still uttering with a sigh Trafalgar's
name,
Where last he conquer'd, where—alas!
he fell.

EPITAPH ON HOWARD.

Ye! who this hallow'd ground with
reverence tread,
Where sleep in honour'd urns the
illustrious dead,
To trace the achievements of the Sons
of Fame,
And pay just worship to each godlike
name;

(If, blest with hearts that melt at human
wo,
And feel philanthropy's celestial glow,)
Midst all the monuments that court
your view,
And claim the debt to buried merit due,
Mark chiefly this;—on this with tearful
eyes
More fondly gaze;—beneath it Howard
lies!

O'er other urns mere mortals only
mourn;
Celestial Beings honour Howard's urn;
Benevolence sits weeping on his stone;
Heaven's Angel still, though on her
earthly throne.

EPITAPH ON VOLTAIRE.

Here lies interr'd Voltaire; no letter'd
name
Can boast more brilliant, more
extensive fame.
On him what various gifts did heaven
confer!—
Poet, historian, wit, philosopher;
But ah!—peruse it, Christian, with a
tear—
The chief of infidels lies buried here:
Lament the abuse of such rare talents
given;

Lament such dire ingratitude to
heaven.

EPITAPH ON NAPOLEON.

Lo! here, on this lone isle amid the
 deeps,
From his proud height of conquest,
 greatness hurl'd,
Buried in silent night, Napoleon sleeps!
Long Gallia's boast, the wonder of the
 world!

Though humbly born, Ambition claim'd
 her child;
Fate urged him on, his great career to
 fill;
On him, in war, in dangers, Fortune
 smiled;
And on his eagles Victory waited still.

By battles won, by policy profound,
Kings he dethroned, fill'd Europe with
 dismay:
England alone, of all the nations round,
His power opposed, disdaining to obey.

Forced by the flames of Moscow to
 retreat,
Half his vast host by cold, by famine,
 dies.
Famed Waterloo beheld his last defeat;

There sunk his glory's sun;—ne'er more
to rise.

Briton! from this sad spot ere thou
depart,
Pause!—while his shade complains in
Fancy's ear;—
'Had generous feeling warm'd thy
Sovereign's heart,
Though Briton's foe, I had not perish'd
here.'

EPITAPH ON LORD BYRON.

Lo! Byron's tomb!—
Here, deeply pensive,
scan
The greatness,—and the littleness of
man.
In timeless death here Freedom's
Martyr sleeps,
Whom, her lost Champion, Greece,
desponding, weeps.
The impassion'd Bard, whose Genius,
wing'd with flame,
Swept, like a comet, through the sphere
of fame,
Dazzling the astonish'd world, lies
buried here.
Thus human Glory ends its bright
career.

To Byron what high gifts did heaven
impart!
An intellect sublime, a feeling heart;
But ah! his wild desires, his passions
strong,
Hurried him irresistibly along
Wherever Pleasure call'd, through good,
or ill;
No law could bridle his own proud self-
will.
O! had but Virtue ruled his mighty
mind,
Byron had been—the first of human
kind!

EPITAPH ON SIR SAMUEL ROMILLY.

What, what can knowledge, virtue,
fame, avail?
Crown they with happiness our mortal
state?
Ah! no: what dire, unthought-of woes
assail!
O wretched Man! thou art the slave of
fate.

Lo! Romilly, in pangs, expiring lies!—
His frantic hand—O horror!—doom'd
to bleed?—
His wakening Conscience opes her
frighted eyes—
'O God!' she groans, 'I disavow the
deed.'

His guardian Angel sheds a pitying tear;

—

Then, fearless of the heavenly Judge's

ire,

He leads his Spirit, blushing to appear,

Into the holy presence of her Sire.

EPITAPH ON WILBERFORCE.

—

Champion of justice and humanity,

He toil'd, through life, to set the Negro

free:

At length, Britannia spoke the godlike

word—

Burst were the bonds, the shouts of

Freedom heard!

Thy life-bonds, too, O Wilberforce!

were riven,

Thy task was done,—it was thy call to

heaven!

EPITAPH.

—

Mortal! whoe'er thou art, that passest

by,

Stop, and behold this stone with
 heedful eye!
Here lies a Youth, whom Death's
 resistless power,
In health's full vigour, at the festal
 hour,
All unprepared, alas! to meet his
 doom,
Snatch'd suddenly to an untimely
 tomb.

Mortal take heed!—in awful silence
 think,
Thou stand'st upon Eternity's dread
 brink;
O listen to Religion's warning cry!—
'Man, know thy nature, and prepare
 to die!'

TRANSLATED FROM ANACREON.

Though thou hast seen my locks are
 gray,
Ah! do not, Julia, turn away;
Nor, though the bloom of Spring is
 thine,
Disdainfully my love decline.
Behold yon wreath!—how lovely
 shows
The snowy lily with the blushing rose!

EPIGRAMS.

ON HEARING OF THE BURNING OF MOSCOW.

May European Liberty
In Moscow's flames her
 torch relume!
And Gallic Tyranny
In Moscow's ruins find a
 tomb!

Locke says—the soul may
 slumber;—
Lavater says—the soul is
 seen
Reflected in the mien;—
The last assertion true,
Proofs of the first we
 view
In faces without number.

TO A HYPOCRITICAL CALVINIST.

By faith alone, you say, not
 works,

Man must obtain
salvation;—
If you are saved, the
doctrine needs
No better confirmation.

My Lady Sceptical, for
want of proof,
What all believe, denies;
Yet she believes what all,
with proof, deny,
That she is wondrous
wise.

'The dullest ass may write
In verse, that jingling
stuff!'
Indeed, Sir? have you
tried?
'I have.' That's proof
enough.

Yon fop has strangely got it
in his noddle
That he excels in tragic
declamation;
Kemble's the favourite, and
the model,
That claims his praise, and
prompts his
imitation;

Now, that the praise is just,
 none can deny;
But the imitation gives that
 praise the lie:
Decide, ye Critics! for 'tis
 hard to know,—
Is he to Kemble's fame a
 friend or foe?

TO JULIA.

Mark! how the Rose, when Phœbus
 burns,
 Averts her blushing face;
Mark! how the Sun-flower fondly turns
 To meet his warm embrace:
Like the coy rose, when woo'd by
 others, be,
Like the fond sun-flower, Love, when
 woo'd by me.

The Chancellor keeps the conscience of
 the King.
This seems, at first, a strange,
 mysterious thing;
But there's a deep-laid policy in it;
For, did the Chancellor not—that
 conscience keep,
It might, perchance, be doom'd on
 thorns to sit;

Seated on wool, it may securely sleep.

Papist and Protestant can ne'er agree.
"Pat!"—cries an Englishman—"tis
clear to me,
More grateful for the union you should
be;
Think what an honour is to Ireland
done:
Zounds! John Bull wed a whore of
Babylon!"
"Murther!"—cries Pat—"he wedded
her by force,
And, by my shoul, she longs for a
divorce."

**ON THE NEW EXPERIMENT OF LIGHTING THE HOUSE
OF COMMONS BY MEANS OF GAS-PIPES PLACED
BETWEEN THE TWO CEILINGS.**

Too long within the House has
darkness dwelt,
Egyptian darkness, by the nation felt;
Therefore, though demagogues,
whose deeds are ill,
For blind debate might love that
darkness still,
'Tis well the new experiment to try:
A stronger, purer light—none can
deny—

Will then illumine the House—light
coming from on high.

'Not one of all my actors, rot 'em!'
Cried Hal,—'can play the part of
Bottom.'

"Play it yourself;"—retorted Ned,—
"You'll look quite natural with an
ass's head."

ON SEEING MR. NUTES,

**A SENSELESS, UNFEELING FELLOW, WEEP AT THE
REPRESENTATION OF KING LEAR.**

Henceforth at miracles who'll dare to
mock?
No wonder Orpheus' lyre could move
the brutes,
Or Moses' rod strike water from the
rock;
Lo! Shakspeare's genius melts the heart
of Nutes,
Draws tears of pity from a barber's
block!

A quack, a mere anatomy,
Wanting to buy a nag,

Questions his friend, a wag,
What colour it shall be:—
'White,' he replies, 'let it be white, of
course,
For then you'll look like Death on the
pale horse.'

**ON THE
LATE REFORM AND THE WHIG
ADMINISTRATION.**

Reform! reform! cries out the
longing nation;—
The people hail their own-elected
House;
On tiptoe stands the general
expectation:—
What the grand doings of the
Administration?
Lo! from the labouring mountain
creeps a mouse!

Metaphysical Sages
Have writ many pages,
To decide if the Mind
Be Spirit or Matter:—
How strange! that in the
pages
Of these metaphysical
sages
We so seldom can find

Mind, Spirit, or Matter!

TO A
**CONCEITED & AFFECTED, BUT
HANDSOME WOMAN.**

Why, when I praise you, Ma'am, why
tell me flat,
All flattery you despise?—
Self-love, the greatest flatterer, tells you
that,
And I am sure he lies.

What a strong contrast to most modern
sages
Were some philosophers of ancient
ages!
E'en Socrates, so wise, yet modest too,
Own'd he knew only that he nothing
knew.
Now! vain pretenders such presumption
show,
They seem to fancy that they all things
know.
Ye moderns, thus puff'd up with vanity,
Would that ye knew but half as much as
he!

ON TWO SISTERS WHO ARE ALWAYS QUARRELLING.

Pale is Amelia's face,
And red Lavinia's nose is;
The sisters ever jar:
'Tis like the civil war
Between the rival roses.

On that dark theme, man's genealogy,
How strangely people's notions
disagree!—
Sir Snub-nose, growling, swears that he
can trace
Strong kindred likeness to the monkey-
race:—
My Lady Graceful smiles, well-pleased,
to find
Far more resemblance to the Angelic-
kind:—
Sure the reflection from their looking-
glasses
Into their minds,—to prompt opinion—
passes.
Would-be philosophers have tried to
scan
The pedigree of that odd creature, man.
'We are of monkey-race!' Sir Snub-nose
cries.
Your strange assertion strikes me with
surprise;
(I, for my part, the compliment decline)
—
But do you, Sir, sincerely thus opine?

'I do indeed: nay more, I'm sure 'tis
true!'
Is't possible?—Yet, when I look on you,
—
I, verily, begin to think so too.

'Oh! Doctor! I've had such a headache
—so bad!
I was fearful I should have gone out of
my senses.'
"I should not have wonder'd, dear
Ma'am, if you had,
You'd not have to go far to leap over
those fences."

**ON THE CONDUCT OF SOME FEW CLERGYMEN, WHO
ARE A DISGRACE TO THEIR SACRED PROFESSION.**

Satan, says scripture, like a roaring
lion,
Goes about, seeking whom he may
devour.
What should a priest, then, chiefly keep
his eye on?
To guard his flock against the tempter's
power.—
Pshaw! what he chiefly looks at is to
fleece 'em:
To seize his prey, the tithes, and still
increase 'em:

Like a devouring lion is the priest;
Or—give the devil his due—you'll own,
 at least,
He has the marks about him of the
 beast.

Why, Sir, so proud to sign your name
 M.D.?
'It means I'm member of the Faculty.'
Hum!—from your practice else one
 might infer
It meant mock-doctor, or death's
 minister.

ON THE MARCH OF INTELLECT.

'March on! march swiftly on!' the
 people cry,
Let us pursue Truth, Knowledge,
 Liberty!
March not so fast, my friends! or you
 will find,
That, in your haste, you've left them
 all behind.

One day Maria, that keen-witted
 Belle,

Challenged her Beau to play at
Bagatelle.
'What shall we play for?'—Edwin
quickly cried;
"Whate'er you please;" the smiling
girl replied.
'Then for a kiss, fair lady, we will
play.'
He wins the game, and straight
demands his pay.
"No"—'Yes'—"I wont"—'You
shall'—"I wont be kiss'd:
I'll pay you with a check—if you
persist."

ON HEARING MR. ** BOAST THAT HE COULD
TRANSLATE VIRGIL.**

Thou able, boaster! Virgil to
translate!
Can'st thou, then, be so vain, so
shallow-pated?
To a far higher intellectual state,
Coxcomb! thou must, thyself, be first
translated.

A lady had a sickly son;
A skeleton but for his skin:—
Her pretty maid he woo'd, and won;

—
The mother chid him for his sin.—

'Her charms were not to be
withstood,
Too tempting for frail flesh and
blood!
As you, dear Ma'am, must fairly
own.'
"That's no excuse for skin and bone."

ON DR. ****,

A MERE PRETENDER TO MEDICAL SCIENCE, OFFICIOUSLY
OFFERING ME HIS SERVICES.

'Should you e'er be unwell, send
directly for me;
To cure you I'll haste with all
possible speed,
Prescribe and find medicine without
any fee.'—
Oh! Doctor! your offer's most
generous indeed;
I'd accept—but for something—the
vast obligation.
'But for what, pray?'—The instinct of
self-preservation.

If, as Swift says, in the most delicate
mind
Nastiest ideas we are sure to find,

Then—equal to his humour and his
wit
Swift's delicacy we must all admit.

**ON HEARING A PARSON READ VERY BADLY A
SERMON HE HAD BOUGHT.**

That sermon, reverend Sir, which
you have bought,
To save your idle brain the toil of
thought,
You read in such a dull, lethargic
tone,
It seems almost as stupid as your
own.

Pursefull's a stickler for the law's
abuse:—
To him, 'tis clear, it was of sterling
use.

Pursefull still advocates the law's
abuse.—
What moralist can gratitude
condemn?
They, formerly, have done so much
for him;

Ought he not, now, to do his best for
them?

TO MR. BURY, AN EMINENT SURGEON IN COVENTRY,

**ON HIS HAVING PERFORMED A SUCCESSFUL OPERATION, IN A
CASE OF DEEPLY-SEATED INFLAMMATION IN THE NECK,
WHEN THE PATIENT WAS IN EXTREME DANGER OF
IMMEDIATE SUFFOCATION.**

Bury, for practice bold and skill
Deserves to be of note;
He cures by means that well might
kill,—
He cuts his patient's throat!

When Satan tempts a priest to rise,
'It is the call of heaven!' he cries,
And mount's ambition's ladder:—
To heaven's own call that bids him
be,
Like Christ, full of humility,
He's deafer than an adder.

**AFTER HAVING SEEN SEVERAL BAD PAINTINGS OF
THE DEATH OF SIR JOHN MOORE.**

Cease, daubers! profane not the
theme, I implore ye!
But leave him, O leave him alone
with his glory!

Man's owl-eyed reason—Popish
Priests assert—
Can't safely bear the gospel's
heavenly light;
Therefore, with kindest zeal, they do
their best
To keep their flocks in unillumined
night.

'The brokers of the Stock-Exchange
Are nicknamed bears and bulls;—
how strange!
What reason, Sir, to call them so?'
Ma'am, see their manners, you will
know.

**ON HEARING A LADY TALK VERY FAST AND
UNINTELLIGIBLY.**

Words upon words impetuous rush
along,
And tread each other's brains out as
they throng.

'Admire my wife! did ever mortal
eyes'—
Cornuto, in a rapture, boasting cries

'Such a fine set of teeth of ivory
view?
And such a fine complexion's ivory
hue?
Fool! hide thy head! both her and
thee we scorn:
Oft the wife's ivory makes the
husband's horn.

I'm told Sir Pigmy mimics me;—
what then?
Don't we all know that monkies
mimic men?
'I cannot say your poem I admire;
It wants originality and fire;
Besides, I find it, by no means,
correct;
You've written it in haste, I should
suspect,'
"What! do you think me then a
jackass, pray?"
'I shall think so if you so loudly bray.'

A worthy man of rags
Intreats for charity
A rogue of money-bags.
'Pshaw! it at home begins.'
Then serve thyself and me;
For it will be no less
A cover to thy sins,
Than to my nakedness.

The Fair-one, at her toilet, thus
express
The ambitious aims that swell'd her
panting breast:
'Pull, Fanny, pull again, with all your
might;
I must, to-day, be laced up very tight;
For, to a glorious conquest I aspire:

Know, that two Noblemen my
charms admire!
Pull, then, good girl! I'll be so tightly
laced,
That half-a-yard will measure round
my waist.'
'Hold!' Cupid cries, 'for Love's, for
Pity's sake;
You'll strangle Beauty, and my
bowstring break.'

In altering thus and shortening his
oration,

Sure the Reporters do Lord Flimsy
wrong;
It well may fill his Lordship with
vexation,
When he has toil'd so hard to make it
long.
'I've writ an epigram;—here, read it,
do.—
The critics praise it highly:—what
think you?'
"I don't much like it." 'No! 'tis very
fine.'
"It may be to your taste—'tis not to
mine."
'I say 'tis finely pointed.' "Well! so be
it!—
The point may be too fine for me to
see it."
'Then, let me tell you, Sir, you must
be blind.'
"Many more like me I'm afraid you'll
find."

Wise radicals! to make it bear more
fruit,
They fain would tear the tree up by
the root.
Young trees, we know, may
sometimes thrive
transplanted,
But old ones can't;—'tis by all
gardeners granted.
'Twill die;—and when the good old
tree is dead,

What sort of tree, pray, will they
plant instead?

The Squire has long imagined that
his son

Is deeply studying Coke and
Lyttelton.

They meet.—'Dear Tom! to see you
gives me joy.—

How get you on in Law? my clever
boy!

In practice too?—But Tom, what
bills you draw!

Expensive work this studying of the
law!'

The sly young Templar gulls his easy
Sire:—

"O! I get on, Sir, to my heart's desire;
In chamber-practice I have much to
do."—

His answer—in a certain sense—is
true.

To move her lover, a coquetish Miss
Began to sob, pretending she should
faint;—

Her maid restored her straight by
whispering this:

'I fear, my lady, you forget your
paint.'

**ON THE MANY VIOLENT DISPUTES AMONG THE
PREACHERS OF THE GOSPEL.**

The labourers in the vineyard toil
(So numerous are their creeds)
Far less to cultivate the soil,
Than break each others' heads.

'Write epigrams! why, Sir, there's
nothing in it.
I would be bound—the merest scribbler
could—
To write one in a minute.'
No doubt you could—but then there
would
Indeed, be nothing in it.

The ambitious rage of Russia nought
controls,
With her vast empire she'd unite the
Poles.

**ON HEARING A CLERGYMAN PREACH A DULL
SERMON IN A LOUD, SHRILL VOICE.**

Still, still his bell-like voice rings
 through my head;
Yet not one bright thought cheers my
 mental view;
O! would that I were deaf, asleep, or
 dead!
Ye marble statues! how I envy you!

To hear him preach the Methodistic
 creed,
What eager crowds to Ranter's chapel
 speed!
His eloquence the harden'd sinner
 frightens;
Like heaven itself—says Fame, he
 thunders, lightens.
I go to hear him;—Fame has made a
 blunder;—
I see no lightning, though I hear the
 thunder.

For flowery sermons Doctor Drudge
 Of preachers at the top is;—
If from their influence we may judge,
 His flowers are only poppies.

Sir! you're both fool and knave!—to
 Frank, Blunt cries—
I know I am, Sir, Frank to Blunt replies:

Now, in self-knowledge if all
knowledge lies,
A fool, like Frank, must be extremely
wise!

Vice is a mouse-trap, pleasure is the
bait,
Like mice, enticing mortals to their
fate;
And of this truth experience leaves no
doubt;—
'Tis far more easy to get in than out.

Old maids their spleen on marriage
vent;—
The reason would you know?
'Tis not, that others are made wives,
But that they can't be so.

How grave he looks! how mighty wise!
—
He seems Minerva's sacred bird:—
He speaks! our ears refute our eyes—
The cackling of a goose is heard.

How came that Jew, deform'd and old,
To wed the youthful, fair Coquette?—
Ben had a purse well-stored with gold!
He caught her in't;—'twas Hymen's net!
Flirtilla's teeth, well-form'd and white,
Were Hymen's pincers, and could bite!

When the Royal Exchange to the
flames fell a prey,
All the Monarchs and Queens from
their niches were thrown;
Lackaday! on the pavement in
fragments they lay,
Every one except Charley the Second
alone.
Strange event! O my Muse! to blind
mortals below
Clear this mystery which none but
immortals can know.
"Cytherea and Momus pray'd Vulcan to
spare
The blithe, amorous King:—Vulcan
granted their prayer."

H. MERRIDEW, PRINTER, COVENTRY.

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